

**ela's
performance**
a romantic wife-watching novel

Arnica Butler

Thirteenth Line Publications



ELA'S PERFORMANCE

A Romantic Wife-Watching Novel

By Arnica Butler

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TO MY READERS

(I started writing these and I can't stop.)

There isn't too much I want to say about this novel before you read it, except that I hope you enjoy it. For those who sometimes ask me where I get my inspiration, I often tell them it's a mix of my real life, and people-watching.

There's a lot in these pages from the first of those categories.

But I'll never say *what*...

Thanks to all my readers, whose continued support makes it possible for me to keep bringing these stories to you. As always, I hope you enjoy reading my story as much as I enjoyed writing it.

Thank you,
Arnica

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ANOTHER COCKTAIL PARTY

Danger was brewing.

I was far away from Ela, but I could see the agitation building up inside of her. She was sliding her forefinger, with increasing violence, over the curve of her wine glass. Her lower lip was just slightly sucked in to her mouth, and she was gnawing on it gently. All things most people wouldn't even notice.

Any minute, she was going to blow.

If people didn't know Ela well, and few people at this party did, they could easily be deceived by her appearance. She was small, with girlish proportions, and the delicate gestures of a ballerina. Her dark brown hair fell just above her breasts. She cut it in a very classic, very timeless style that would be out of place in no decade or setting. Her eyes, an inviting shade of golden brown, were framed by long, straight lashes that gave her the appearance of a sleepy doe. She had inherited the small, well-sculpted Mediterranean features of her maternal Spanish heritage: her nose had a slight aquiline quality to it that radiated cuteness; her lips were full and pretty; she had a single, slightly crooked tooth in her smile; and her cheeks seemed perpetually flushed in a light shade of pink.

As a result of all of this, she looked sweet.

Misleading. Ela is short for Graciela, and there is a reason that she anglicized it to "Ela" as opposed to "Grace."

I watched her. Her nostril was flaring slightly.

I excused myself from the conversation I had only been half-listening to anyway, because I was always on heightened alert for Ela's temper flaring. Especially at cocktail parties. Especially at cocktail parties at our house, which almost always ended with me holding her flailing wrists in the hallway while she whisper-yelled at me: "Don't tell me what I can and can't say in my own house!"

Which was fine. Whatever. The price of marrying Ela. But it also usually ended up with me sleeping on the couch, which I found annoying to say the least.

I squeezed myself between Aaron Leming and a paralegal he was attempting to seduce. It was rude, but I needed a direct line to my wife.

I smiled at Aaron. "Just after my wife," I explained.

Aaron's eyes jerked away from his pretty paralegal prey and sought out Ela. He had seen this all before, and he didn't want to miss a moment of the action.

He smiled.

Aaron, it should be said, was kind of a jerk.

But back to Ela, who was boiling over like a pot.

The man in front of Ela was a manager at Gyrric Systems, an enormous client of ours. He was a big man, a boring man, a staunch Republican man, a bottom-line man, all of which, by itself, probably had Ela's hair frizzed. I already knew where this conversation was going, from the way his arms were folded and he was leaning toward Ela, as though to hear her better...

"Well," I heard his voice rumble, ending in a haughty chuckle, and I braced myself. "It's a good thing your husband has a real job then, is all I have to say."

Great. It was worse, way worse than I had thought.

I had no idea what to do, so I jumped into the group awkwardly and yelled:

"Can I get anyone a drink?!" I used a hammy cockney accent and hopped around a bit zanily.

Since I am originally British, tall, and sort of ginger-headed, this sort of thing never fails to amuse groups of Americans. I've been using it for 15 years. Everyone made an instant semi-circle around me and opened their mouths in expressions of exaggerated surprise. Tom, a good guy to the end, who also knows Ela's legendary temper, and so knew we were all on the edge, shouted helpfully:

"Oh, hey, the barrister is here!"

And I began to take drink orders.

A crimson stain of anger was creeping up Ela's cheeks. I had only one shot at diffusing her, and it worked about 50% of the time.

Humor. All women loved a good sense of humor, or so they said.

It was tricky with Ela, though. The joke that would save me had to be smart, but smart jokes sometimes went too far.

I took a few drink orders in my theatrical Geico Gecko accent. This was not for Ela's benefit, because this particular accent actually annoyed her, but it would buy me some time.

When I turned to Ela, she had brought her empty wine glass to her chest and had folded her arm over her elbow. Her eyes were orange with rage, but her face was relaxed.

It could still go either way.

“Get me a very inexpensive, very dark red wine that I can throw at someone,” she seethed.

I spun through my options. She was definitely tipping toward rage.

I summoned my best and most fanciful bow, and campiest cockney accent. “And your husband will be paying for that, I presume?”

It was a long shot. But once Ela's eyes have gone practically red there isn't much left *but* a long shot.

Her face was still for a moment. Frozen in an expression of just-below-the-surface fury. Ela never pressed her lips together, she just did a thing with her face that made it seem like she did. Stiffened them somehow. I could almost *see* the ire snaking through her veins like a demonic spirit.

My heart was stopped, hardened with fear.

Truth be told, Gary or Greg Schmidt or Smith or whoever he was, from Gyrrix, was an arse. Letting Ela loose on him to verbally shred him to pieces was not entirely unamusing to me.

But it would create a mess. A real shit-storm of client-relations, social-circles, networking-and-etc. proportions.

I watched her face carefully, and my still blood began to circulate again when I saw a flicker of amusement twitch in her right eye. Her lips softened a little.

I blinked hopefully.

She smiled, and spun a quarter-turn, and walked away, rolling her eyes.

Tom raised his eyebrows and turned his thumb up for me. He handed Greg or Gary a drink.

Good thinking, good man. Get something in his mouth before we have a situation.

I went to the kitchen, and hummed cheerfully while pouring drinks. Behind me, Ela leaned on the counter, swirling her wine and fuming death rays in my direction. Or amused-rays, rays of cheerful camaraderie. It was impossible to know with her, until they hit you in the face just ahead of whatever she decided to say.

Like any woman of Spanish descent (or so I am told), Ela was a lovely, laughing, pleasant, passionate person.

Until she was pissed. In the American sense of the word.

Then everyone – and I mean everyone – had better get out of the way.

I turned to her, and found her smiling. This meant nothing: she could still blow.

It was terrifying.

But she was sexy as hell.

I gave a spin as I left through the swinging door. Fingers crossed.

I settled into a group with Aaron Leming and my buddy Tom, hoping that the combination would attract Ela to our circle and not leave her careening about the room like an asteroid on a crash-course. Ela liked Tom, and I knew she enjoyed Aaron's leering at her, albeit in a perverse way. Aaron was a playboy and Ela wouldn't touch him with a ten-foot pole (of this I felt sure), but she got a pleased flush on her face whenever she was around him. The kind pretty women get when they know good-looking men are watching them with approval.

"That was a close one," Tom said, jovially. He looked approvingly in Ela's direction as she emerged from the kitchen. I noted that she had refilled her wine glass, and danger warnings flickered in my mind.

I think Tom enjoyed sharing in the responsibilities of keeping Ela from flaring up. I could tell, by the way he looked at her like she was a museum object, that he thought all the time about reaching out and touching her porcelain skin, and then resisted the urge. Ela, for her part, did nothing but encourage Tom's adoration of her, because she was sharp-witted and so was Tom, and she liked the banter. I knew her sparkling eyes and quick mind brewed some very naughty thoughts about my wife in Tom's head.

Aaron's eyes were all over Ela, all the time – but then, his eyes were on every woman all of the time, starting with the hottest one in the room. "Smashing dress, Ela," he said, as she passed him. He let his eyes take a lingering walk over her small breasts, tucked beneath the black chiffon that hung over her like an oversized shirt. The chiffon was transparent, and tantalizingly offered a view of the black sheath of a dress underneath it, clinging to Ela's small but well-turned ass, her narrow waist, and her pert breasts. The sheath was also very short, and Ela's long, Barbie-doll legs

were almost entirely out of it. The chiffon “shirt” cloaked the otherwise hooker-ish dress in respectability.

Ela extended her middle finger at Aaron and pushed past him as if she were on an errand.

Aaron spun around and watched her disappear into the next room. “Mmmm,” he said. “How in the hell did *you* get that woman to even talk to you? She has such a nice, tiny little a-”

“What happened to your secretary?” Tom interrupted. He usually loved some trash-talking about women's asses, but he had a different kind of appreciation of Ela and he wasn't about to let Aaron say the word *ass*. Not if it was Ela's ass we were talking about.

“Bathroom,” Aaron said, shrugging. “I have that in the bag.” His mind was still on Ela. “Seriously *that dress*.”

Ela, for unknown reasons, was passing us again. She stopped and cast a glowering eye on Aaron.

“Hello, Tom,” she said. Her voice was pleasant for Tom, but her eyes were still glaring at Aaron. They flicked to Tom and warmed, and her mouth melted into a smile. “I see you've got your power tie on tonight.”

Her tone was affectionate. Tom smiled and smoothed his ugliest tie against his shirt. “I have indeed. One can never be too powerful at a cocktail party.”

“Or a flea market.”

I watched the two of them exchange their silly, private jokes. Perversely, I almost liked it. Whenever Ela laughed at Tom and touched his arm, I felt a little sliver of pain stab me in the chest.

Not a really bad one, just a pleasantly fleeting feeling that my wife was flirting with another man.

I allowed myself a swig of whiskey, and began to relax. Ela hovered for moment with us, and she looked like she was calmed and pacified by Tom's corny jokes.

But it wasn't over.

I relaxed too much, and lost track of my wife.

Never a good idea.

Somehow, through the magic of cocktail parties, Ela ended up back in an eddy of people who included Greg or Gary, and the topic must have swung back to The Arts, or Ela, or both. I eased myself from the cluster I

was in and tried to get there on time, but I was too late. He had finished his sentence and rage had fallen like a curtain over Ela's face.

I stopped short of the group. It was too late. I could see that. In the corner of my eye I saw Tom's face, a little horrified.

"So," Ela said. She cleared her throat and spun the wine in her glass in a slow, perfect wave around the glass – a talent she had, and also a sign that she was about to explode - "You would abolish funding for the arts. I *see*." There was a pause here, and I could tell by the way the word *see* had left her mouth chewing at the air with sharp little teeth, that something terrible was coming next.

Her voice changed, sweet now, like nectar in a Venus flytrap:

"But *wherever* would you wear all your fancy clothes and demonstrate how *cultured* you are for all the other intelligentsia of the corporate world?"

Silence. A few open mouths waved uselessly at the air.

I held my breath.

There was always the chance that he hadn't really followed what she was saying.

Greg (I remembered with sudden, perfect clarity at that moment, that *Greg* was in fact his name. I could see it so clearly now, printed clearly at the bottom of a letter dissolving our attorney-client relationship) made an odd face, one that was neither amused nor angry. He gave a short, uncomfortable laugh.

Ela tipped her head back and dropped the rest of her wine into it, shrugged, and set the glass on the table behind her. She winked at me and walked off.

Someone cleared their throat, and we began to talk about a recent acquisition in the business world that affected no one and was barely interesting. Someone had thankfully read that week's *Economist*, and we all thanked him silently for having done so.

Ela's comment hung in the air, of course, like the smell of burnt cooking. Not long after that, people began to leave with abrupt excuses.

And thusly, my wife ended another cocktail party.

LATER THAT NIGHT

Ela was brushing her teeth furiously.

I knew she wanted me to say something to her, because I knew *she* knew she had been out of line. But I also knew there was no point bringing it up. Or saying that. Not if I didn't want to be clobbered in my sleep.

I tossed the bed cover down and flopped onto the bed.

Ela looked at me through the mirror. She paused in her brushing, and then started again.

She spat.

"You don't have anything to say, then?" she seethed.

"About what, darling?" I teased.

Ela groaned. "Oh my god, you *are* annoying. About your stupid, *stupid* client, and me ruining your stupid, *stupid* party."

"Did that happen? When did that happen? I don't even remember that," I said, squinting at the ceiling as though it might remind me.

The pillow came out of nowhere and hit me hard enough to spray stars across the inside of my eyelids. Expected.

But then Ela jumped on top of me, straddling me, and pressed the pillow onto my face.

Playfully, mind you. But there was always an element of reality in Ela's 'games.'

I easily caught her wrists in my hand, and not-so-easily pried her away from the pillow.

By now, her small, feisty frame had wriggled on top of me, with her soft skin against my legs, and I had an erection. When I nudged the pillow out of the way and looked up at her, I was relieved to see that she was grinning, playfully. Her hair was disheveled sexily, and she bit her slightly crooked tooth into her front lip. She was wearing a very thin white cotton shirt, and I could see the shape of her breasts through it, the darkness of her skin, and if she only held still, the hard, brown pebble of her nipple.

"Aggggh!" she yelled. "These people you work with are such tools!"

She tried, not very hard, to wriggle her wrists away from my grip.

"What's the other word you used, the one I liked so much?"

“Asshats.”

I laughed and threw her to the side, climbing on top of her.

She was struggling, but for show. If she had really been trying, it would have been much more work. Ela was small but fierce, with a lot of electricity coiled up inside of her that she could tap for a spurt of furious strength is she wanted to.

Her mind worked the same way.

But today she fought at only half-power, just enough to get me excited, because she knew I liked it. I grasped both of her wrists with one hand and held them above her head. She rewarded me with a jut of her jaw, and a little grin before opening her mouth in a light gasp.

I moved my other hand down her writhing body, small and taut with excitement. I could feel the warmth of her skin through her thin cotton nightie, and my fingers were eager to push the cotton away so that I could get at the smooth, hot surface of her. I pushed my hand under the fabric, along her small frame, over each tiny rib that I could feel beneath her skin. As I did she squirmed and giggled, but her body arched upward toward me. Wanting me.

I pushed myself up, pushing her hands down, and she winced a little at the slight pain of her wrists being pressured into the pillow. She twisted feebly to get more comfortable, but I distracted her by brushing over her breasts. Her skin dimpled with bumps of excitement beneath my fingers, and under my palm her dark chocolate nipple pebbled. Her breathing turned to deep, coarse pants, like an animal. In my hand her wrists went almost limp as she gave herself over to me.

I moved my hand downward to her panties, made of the same thin white fabric, revealing the color of her trim bush, dark like her hair, silky and fine, advertising far more youth than she actually possessed. It was easy to find her slit, and work my forefinger into her hot flesh.

I shivered as her wet, scorching lips closed around my finger, thinking of how the same delightful sensation would envelop my cock in only a few moments. In just a few moments, I would be inside of her, and her eyes would close like a cat's and she would purr while I enjoyed the deepest part of her.

My fingertip found the hardened knob of her clit, and slid over it in her honeyed wetness. A ripple moved through her, hard and complete, as I rubbed the hypersensitive skin at the center of her clit. Her lips parted, and

her sweet breath, still flavored with wine and a cinnamon candy she had eaten, escaped her mouth.

Ela often ate things like bubble gum, and then washed them down with wine, or she snuck a cigarette with a busker friend after eating some Fun Dip. The intoxicating effect of her young appearance, and the taste of something childish mixed with something adult and illicit in her mouth never failed to get me wired. Like now. I plunged into her mouth, and the combination of the childishly-sweet cinnamon, and the dry red wine she had knocked back, made my whole body tense.

I pushed her panties down her hips, almost frantic now to be inside of her. I wonder, often, if Ela knew how much I craved her, until I became like an addict, clawing my way into her like some junkie fumbling with a rubber hose.

I held my breath, and tried to steady myself, stroking her clit and trying to bring her to orgasm before I entered her. Her eyelids, and her long lashes, were fluttering to half-mast now, and her breathing was quick. Her body became harder and harder beneath me, as her orgasm built up inside of her.

She exhaled, and then didn't take another breath. A low moan warbled her throat as she wound up tighter and tighter, with my finger sliding over the smooth cap of her clit. Her pussy was welling up with her tangy juices, and my finger was sloshing between the lips of her cunt now.

And then I felt it: the shudder of her body as she came. She gritted her teeth together and gave a light yelp. Her orgasm almost always seemed to pass through her and into me. My cock throbbed almost painfully as I watched her face flush and the breath ripple her nostrils as she exhaled hard and fast.

This is, though it's rather mundane, the way we most often made love. Me, playing her like an instrument, until she burst. And then I rolled on to her, and slid my prick into her gushing, pulsing pussy. The heat of her enveloped me, and she wrapped her small body around me. Her heels crossed at the small of my back, and I released her wrists so that she could cling to me and dig her fingers into my shoulders.

And then I fucked her, as she held on and squeezed my cock with her magnificently tight cunt, slippery with cum. She would usually come again, if I made it that long, and when she did she would yell and throw back her head. Or bite my shoulder.

But tonight I was too worked up, and I could feel myself close to bursting in no time at all. I opened my mouth to tell her so, but her eyes were closed anyway. I felt the soft, superheated walls of her cunt clench one last time, and I yelled as I filled her pussy.

I collapsed onto her body, my nose in the soft dip between her collarbone and shoulder. Her nightie had gone all akimbo and I could nuzzle her there. She smelled like wine, cinnamon, her silly strawberry shampoo, and beneath it all, like herself – a sweet, woody smell. Like rain, bread, honey, and moss.

“You're altogether too heavy to be lying on me like this,” she complained, pushing against me. She was smiling, but she was serious.

When Ela was done, she was done.

Reluctantly, I peeled my body away from hers. I was gratified that she turned toward me, and placed her cheek on my chest. She untangled an arm from the sheets and drew lazy circles on my stomach.

At moments like this, I believed Ela loved me as much as I loved her.

But most of the time, I felt like I was the one who was obsessed. I had no hand. I tried to remind myself that she had moved her for me, that she had given up her career for me, that she had sacrificed so many things for me.

But it never took away the unease that I felt nearly all the time, but especially in the bedroom, that I was an addict and Ela could take me or leave me.

Like maybe she would be sad if I were gone or didn't need the inside of her so much. Sad the way people are sad to leave a dog at home on vacation.

But not that sad.

I closed my eyes and tried to concentrate on the sensation of Ela's fingers, slowing as her breath slowed and she drifted off to sleep. Her leg twitched, and her mouth opened. Her fingers rested on my chest.

Her eyelashes scraped my skin as she woke suddenly.

She was like this: when she was peeved she couldn't let it go.

“And do you know what really gets me?” she spat suddenly. It wasn't as if I needed to know what the topic was. She was back on Greg again. “That idiot has probably never worked that hard a single day in his life, and he *has* to know that about himself. Or do you think people like that *think*

they actually worked hard while they were guffawing like a twat at 'networking parties' until some other twat gave them a job?"

It was funny she would say this, because I had heard her, on more than one occasion, make the exact same statements about people with good careers in music, who had talent but also mostly the patience to schmooze.

"I think he *thinks* he works hard," I said, giving more thought to her idea than I meant to.

She rolled her eyes. I couldn't see it, but I felt it in the movement of her eyelashes.

"Being a dick, however, comes naturally to him," I added.

I felt Ela's mouth move against my skin, forming a small smile.

"I don't understand why you didn't just explain that you're going back for your doctorate," I said.

Another pillow on my face. Ela released it, and she turned on her side again.

I waited for it, beneath the pillow so that my smile would be hidden when she started in.

"*Why?!*" she breathed suddenly, after a full minute or so, "*why* would I give any legitimacy to that idiot's thoughts by *explaining myself to him*? As if there's -"

She cut herself short.

"You're winding me up, aren't you?"

Ela was a real Anglophile, so she loved to use expressions she gleaned from British TV shows (I certainly didn't say them anymore). I sometimes suspected she had married me because I am a Brit. Then sometimes I suspected her of being disappointed that I wasn't British enough, because by then I was fully Americanized to the point of actually watching football. The kind with the brown ball and all the helmets.

"I am," I said, muffled under the pillow.

"Jesus!" she seethed.

Whether Ela wanted to admit it or not, it was a sore point with her that none of my coworkers took her profession – or her talent – seriously. This was mostly because they had no clue what it took to become a professional musician, or to play like Ela, who was in a class of her own, even within the elite class of musician she was part of. It was also not well-known that Ela had voluntarily given up taking auditions for me. Out of love.

My biggest worry? Time had taken its toll on the adrenaline-soaked love at the beginning of our relationship, and now I knew that the kind of love Ela had for me – steady, true, hardened marital love – was perhaps failing to take the sting out of being a freelance musician instead of one with a solid job in a respected orchestra.

And then there were the snide comments that people made about her job.

The truth was that we probably should have done things differently: I probably should have moved to wherever Ela got a job. But at the time, when we had finally decided to end our trans-Atlantic and long-distance love affair of many years, I was already admitted to the bar. She was just enough in love and still full of youthful caprice that she believed everything would “work out somehow.” What that meant, at the time, hadn't mattered.

Now...now we were here. With a tiny bit of bitterness hanging over us.

Ela curled up next to me, saying no more, and she fell asleep, as she always did once she got things off her chest. Easily, and without troubled thoughts. I stayed awake, as I always did, with doubts and worries, a lot of them centering on Ela.

BACK TO SCHOOL

“Are you all ready for your first day of school?” I teased, sliding an arm around Ela's waist and kissing the back of her neck. She squirmed, and I was pleased to see a ripple of gooseflesh travel down her neck to her collarbone.

“I'm even packing my lunch,” she said, and turned, at that moment, to suck mayonnaise off her thumb.

Seductively? Or not? Who ever knew, with women? I watched her lips close around the tip of her thumb and suck the mayonnaise into her red mouth, and I felt something twitch in my trousers.

“That's cute,” I said, appreciatively, though my mind was on other things.

She turned back to her sandwich, and began encasing it in layer after layer of plastic wrap.

“Are you excited, though?” I asked, opening a cupboard in search of coffee. “Nervous?”

Ela shrugged.

One thing that I found fascinating about Ela is that she did *not* get nervous, which was an ailment I suffered from. I had very deliberately eased myself into contract law for a reason: I was terrified to be in a courtroom, and the more I could stay out of it, the better. I had performance anxiety. I couldn't sleep before a big deposition, or presentation, or meeting.

Ela, on the other hand, did the seemingly impossible, and stood on a stage alone to play a violin solo from memory. When she did her entire body was placid, her heart rate steady and slow like a clock. She never shook, she never lost sleep beforehand, she never had a crack in her voice when she spoke.

Today she was no different, even though she would likely be playing for people's scrutiny all day long. She leaned on the counter to bite into a bagel, and pushed her sandwich and plastic wrap aside to read her horoscope.

Which she did not read aloud, or say anything about. She just munched on her bagel and raised her eyebrows.

“Bad news?”

I know I'm a terrible person, but something inside of me had a desire to rattle Ela a little. It wasn't possible, but I always had to try.

She was just so calm.

She shook her head. And stuffed more bagel into her mouth.

“Oh my god!” she said, a second later. “Madonna is coming here.”

You might think a classical violinist would not actually want to see Madonna, but you would be wrong. Ela's tastes in music ran to other extremes that startled people.

Like Iron Maiden.

“What time do you have to leave?” I inquired.

Her eyes flipped up to the clock, back to the newspaper. A pause. Then she jumped. “Oh shit. I'm late.”

She swung her violin case over her back, and it was only then that I really took notice of what she was wearing.

“New outfit?” I said. A gorgeous wool skirt clung to her hips and flared out coquettishly more than a few inches above her knees. Not short enough to be obscene, but...short. Ela was 27, but her thin frame, her features and her unblemished skin still delivered the illusion of barely legal, especially in a skirt like that.

I'll admit, it was something I liked about her. I was five years older than her and it gave me a thrill to see other guys casting a look at me like I was doing something semi-legal in public by grabbing her ass.

Atop her skirt, she was wearing a white blouse, and she had left the top button unbuttoned, but the buttons were spaced far enough apart that the neckline plunged as a result.

She had braided her hair from the left side of her face to the other, and while it was not pigtails, it was a very young, very fetching, very...*jailbaity*...hairstyle.

I watched as she dropped the left shoulder strap of her violin case onto her shoulder, in a particularly girlish manner. Her blouse dropped open across her chest, almost revealing her bra, and the small, perfectly shaped mounds inside of it.

I pointed at her, and she shook her head to cut me off before I made any patronizing comments. Just to be sure it was clear, she said, dryly: “Don't.”

But I couldn't stop myself. I want to, all the time, but I just *can't*.

“You'd better be careful in that outfit.”

She hooked her thumbs under the straps of her violin case, and tilted her chin up as she fluttered her eyes at me. It was a calculated move. She exaggerated her adolescent appearance by doing it, and she let me know she knew exactly what I was thinking. It was a challenge.

“Why's that, pops?” she said.

I lifted my coffee mug to my lips.

I had to be careful of where this was headed, and that's because Ela knew I was sort of on thin ice.

She cocked her head to the side, and twisted her braid in her fingers.

“All those boys at uni are too young for me,” she said, her voice serrated with a teasing edge. Sucking me in. Driving me crazy. “Unless...” She gasped, theatrically. “You don't think...one of my....instructors would try to....?” She let her mouth hang open in mock surprise.

I smiled.

I mean, she had me there. Because the first time I had fucked Ela was in an unlocked room on the top floor of the philosophy building, on a desk that seemed to be taken from a century schoolhouse. She had been nineteen for two days, and I was her instructor.

SEDUCTION

Anyone could have walked in, and I would have lost my TAship and probably my entire career had anyone done so.

“Professor White?”

I had seen her before. Of course I had seen her. Small and quiet, writing her class notes in tidy block letters, an unusual habit for a girl. Looking perpetually sleepy, as though she had just propped herself up on a pillow next to me.

Now she was standing in the doorway of the small room to which philosophy had been banished, up flights and flights of drafty, institutional stairs and down a hallway with one fluorescent light casting an ugly glow and a vexing buzz on the gray-brown linoleum floor. The room was small and the windows on the top half of the wall, so that no one could look out on what was probably a lovely view.

But even in the fluorescent light, Ela looked lovely. And it was all such a cliché, and I didn't like admitting to anyone, even myself, that one reason I had been willing to do such a stupid, stupid thing as the thing I was about to do, was because she looked quite under-aged, there in the fluorescent light, with her hair twisted into two braids.

There was something so seductive about it all: lurid, naughty, and wrong, but seductive.

“I'm not a professor,” I said, and my voice scraped out of my throat dry and wobbly. “Just a TA.”

Ela smiled. “Just a TA,” she repeated, and her mouth had a curve of mischief to it. A very sexy, very inviting tremble in one corner. Her eyes seemed to glow from the inside, like amber stones. “Okay. TA White?”

I replay the scene in my mind. No, Ela wasn't twisting her two braids in her fingers, like a schoolgirl in a porno. But I remember it that way, somehow.

She had her violin on her back. It looked like a backpack.

“Are these...your office hours?” she said, when I did nothing but stare at her.

“Oh,” I said, a little lost. “Yeah...yes. Come in.”

I didn't really want her to come in. The door was open to the empty hallway and the other empty rooms, but something seemed, very suddenly, wildly inappropriate about having this girl in the office with me alone.

She slid the straps of her case from her shoulders, but the way she did it and the way my mind was working, it was like a striptease.

She was wearing soft, cashmere white sweater that fit snugly against her small frame. Jeans. Nothing racy. She just looked...impossibly cute.

And young.

And hot.

“You play the violin,” I said, idiotically. As though I were informing her of it.

“It's a machine gun.” She set it down with care and ease, and slid into one of the desks. She tucked her feet up, so that she was folded between the desk and the attached seat. She blinked at me with her long lashes. “It's the problem. I'm a music major. I'm totally lost.”

Later of course, this blatant lie would be uncovered: there was nothing about philosophy that had Ela lost.

“Uh...” Normally this type of question irritated me, because students often just hadn't read anything and wanted me to sum it up for them, or give them the questions to the next test, and possibly the answers. There was no way, though, that this girl, looking like a bunny in her white sweater, was going to get any huffiness from me.

I sat down.

It's easy to know, as a man, when you're being a total fucking idiot. When your dick is thinking for you, and when you're reaching for a cookie jar that will definitely get you caught.

It's just so difficult to do anything about it.

I was close to her, and on that particular day she had chewed grape bubble gum to cover up the smell of a strong French cigarette she had smoked with scrawny French cellist who was in love with her. Beneath these two scents was her own skin, not her soap or her shampoo, but the smell of Ela. It rose up through my nostrils and burned me right through my core.

“What is it you're having trouble with?”

Ela unfolded herself and stretched her arms across the desk. Somehow she had sucked up into her arms a copy of the textbook we were

using, and she slid a finger into the pages and flipped it open.

The movement was random, I could see that, and her eyes fell to the open page.

“Plato,” she said.

The electricity between us was almost palpable now, but I was wary. She had her eyes locked on mine and she seemed to be moving closer, at a glacial and nearly undetectable pace. Her grapey, Rothmans's flavored mouth was closer and closer to mine with every passing second.

“Plato,” she repeated, and I had forgotten entirely what it was that we were talking about.

There was a full minute of time where we said nothing. We were just staring at each other. My cock by now had gotten hard and my brain was trying desperately to talk to it, to weigh the consequences that were unfolding in front of me if I moved an inch too close to Graciela Pineiro, whose name I had stared at for so so long in her block handwriting at the top of her very coherent tests and assignments.

She never came to office hours.

It was the middle of the semester and there was no test coming. No hard assignment.

Beneath her white sweater, her skin shifted as she leaned even closer to me. Her eyes looked to the door.

It was weird. We would both say this later. Ela had never been the kind of girl to just jump on men, or so she claimed. I certainly had not imagined myself having the balls to do what came next.

I'm not sure who started it, me or her. Though I feel certain it must have been Ela. Ela who leaned in. I think she said something like, *I'm not really that confused*.

And I said, like all men say, said: *We shouldn't be doing this*.

But maybe that was after she had already stood up, and we were already against the door that we closed with our bodies. Ela took her own white sweater off, of this I am sure. I watched it in slow, disbelieving motion, as she peeled the soft material from her pale skin and it rolled up and up, exposing her soft body inch by inch, until her small breasts, cupped by a lacy cream bra, were pressed against my chest and her mouth was right beneath my lips.

I pushed her against the door, and this was not entirely unbridled passion. Part of me wanted to make sure no one would get through the door

if they came to office hours. Which were still, technically, in. Somewhere in the back of my mind was the awareness that anyone could come in here and there would be no way to hide what was happening. Ela's hair was getting sweaty, clinging to her cheek and her neck. Her face was pink and her sweater was on the floor.

Something about it – the possibility of getting caught like that - drove me even wilder.

I moved my hand over her body and cupped her breast in my palm. As I squeezed her supple flesh, I felt her nipple grow hard against my skin. I slid my thumb beneath the fabric of her bra and stroked her nipple. I was anxious to tear her clothes away, to see what color her nipples were, if they were what I had imagined. To see if the body I had envisioned all semester was the same. Where she had small moles, the color of her skin, the shape of her hip bones beneath her skin.

There was no time for that, though – not there.

Ela herself was the one who slid her jeans off, and then, with a look that dared me to do it, she moved away from the door and sat on the table of the desk she had been sitting in, fully clothed, only a moment ago. Only now her jeans were hanging from one leg, and only a silky bra and a pair of white cotton panties covered her torso.

She winked at me without winking, and she rubbed her tongue along her lip without actually doing so – that was the look she gave me. Her eyes alone told me what she wanted me to know: she wanted me to fuck her.

No, her fingers told me. She moved them down to the line of her panties, and slid them under the fabric. Just quickly. Just enough to draw my eyes to what was there, to pull the fabric away and let me see a peek of her pink flesh, her dark hair, her pink flesh again.

She was sitting on a desk in my classroom. My student. Looking about fifteen with those fucking braids in her hair.

I knew she wasn't – I knew her birth date, it was on my roster, I had checked and re-checked it. It was two days ago. It was nineteen years ago.

Cotton panties.

Her fingers pulled from beneath the material, and I am sure they were wet. The smell of her was the only thing in the room: fresh, ripe, and sweet. The panties snapped against her skin. I looked at her eyes. Yellow-gold in the fluorescent light. The buzz swallowed me in its sound, and I couldn't hear anything else.

I swept my eyes once more over the scene, and all the easy ways for me to get fired and ruin my academic and professional career in a few seconds.

And then my mind was gone.

My fingers fumbled only slightly with my trousers, and then I was out in the cool, still air. I pushed her panties to the side and felt the wetness of her pussy on the tip of my cock, a few soft feathery kisses from her downy hair as I searched for her sweet hole with my throbbing cock.

And then I was in.

No. Maybe I said, one more time: *We shouldn't do this.*

But Ela just pulled me closer, and then I was in.

She leaned back a little on the desk, and I watched her legs bounce as I fucked her – *fucked a student on a desk in a classroom with the door open* – and it was almost too much to make it to any amount of time at all. I looked down as my orgasm built up inside of me, to watch my cock sliding in and out of her little pussy, with her panties scraping against the side of my cock in a way that would have been painful if only I could have had a thought in my head. And the sight nearly sent me over the edge.

She clung to me and pressed up against me, grinding herself against my cock. I was going over, when I realized that her sweet little cunt was clenching tightly around me and she was grinding her way to her own orgasm.

And then, like just another cliché, we both came at the same time, and her pussy turned to hot liquid as we clung to each other on top of the desk. I had been holding her up by the hips and she was suddenly terribly heavy. She laughed as I nearly dropped her.

“I meant to just...somehow get you to ask me out,” she said. Her eyes were unafraid to meet mine. She wasn't embarrassed, and her cool, collected gaze kept me from falling apart. My eyes, though, darted to the door.

Ela stood up and dropped her foot neatly into her jeans, capturing her discarded shoes, like a ballerina slipper, in the same motion. She had her pants zipped by the time she reached the door, and she closed it. She threw her hair back as she stood up, and reached her arms over her head to put on her sweater, which had fallen to the floor.

Her hair tingled with static and her cheeks were pink with contentment. She looked, very suddenly, much more like a nineteen-year

old, and I was relieved. My head was throbbing with my fast-moving blood.

“Say something,” she encouraged me. Smiling. Friendly.

“I...” I searched my mind for something to say. “Thank you.”

How dumb. Ela laughed. She brought her hand to her face and almost keeled over with her wet snort of a laugh.

Then she straightened herself out, and slung her violin over her shoulders.

“I don't actually have a problem with...Plato,” she said.

“No,” I said flatly. What a gorgeous, magnificent, beautiful creature she was. And she was still talking to me. And my cock was covered in her pussy juices. And all I could think about was how I wanted to fuck her again.

“So I'm not blackmailing you,” she said coyly. She wrung her shoulder under the second strap and let it fall on her holder with a dull snap.

“I hadn't even thought of that.”

She moved close to me, and kissed me on my semi-open mouth.

“Okay,” she said. “See you in class then, TA White.”

She saluted me.

She winked at me.

And then she left.

A STRANGE HAZE

And now, even though it was eight years later, and Ela was my wife now, I couldn't help but wonder if some lecherous instructor would, as I did, think entirely with his cock when Ela stepped into his office hours.

In that short skirt and white blouse, a braid over one shoulder.

"Just...be careful," I said, in reference to her outfit. I sounded more flustered than I meant to.

Ela dropped the act and narrowed her eyes. "Oh Peter," she said. "You're *serious*." She was mocking me.

She came closer to me and gave me a bear-hug. I know she was trying to be cute, but it actually irritated me even more. "Peter-otter," she cooed. "You know you'll always be the only professor of mine that I fuck."

"TA," I corrected, though it didn't make any difference.

I wanted to say something else. I wanted both to actually re-iterate my warning, or to tell her to put a different skirt on. I also wanted to erase everything that had come out of my mouth, and bury my jealousy in a place where she couldn't see it.

Because when she did get to see it, she rubbed on it, until it was raw. Maybe she didn't mean to, but she did.

And it was a curious feeling: too hard, too intense, painful.

But also fucking hot as hell.

She kissed me on the mouth. It was a quick kiss, a comical kiss. She rolled her eyes, but I couldn't tell who it was for. Me, for being silly. Or herself, for calling me 'Peter-otter.'

Of course I was being ridiculous.

Of course Ela was a loyal wife, and of course what had happened between us, as teaching assistant and student, as older guy and younger girl, was a one-off. She had just fallen so madly in love with me. That's what she said, and wasn't there evidence enough that she meant it?

She had a house, a loving husband, we were going to start a family soon...

Also, she was 27 now. Not a barely-legal undergrad.

I watched her skip away, down the steps and toward the bus stop. Her walk seemed coquettish. Her skirt seemed adolescently short. Her violin on her back gave her a schoolgirlish quality that was deeply unsettling.

“Jesus, Peter,” I said aloud, and the refrigerator kicked in as if to emphasize my point. “Get a hold of yourself.”

A strange haze came over me that morning. I was surprised by it, and it took me a while to figure out what it was about. After all, I had been the one to suggest that she go back to school and do her doctorate in performance. It would increase her chances of getting a teaching position, at least, and it would give her the chance to practice with discipline and feedback and take auditions again.

I wasn't sure where all of that was going, in the end; but it was going to console me for a while about her loss of career momentum. It would also give her something to say besides “busker” when the snobby people I worked with asked her what she did for a living. The truth was, I didn't really care. But I knew Ela did.

It was strange, then, that her return to school moved into my mind like a fog and refused to leave. I couldn't think straight. She had applied to the program almost a year ago – it wasn't as if this was a shock to anyone. This day had been coming for a long time and I hadn't given it much more thought than I give my choice of breakfast. Until now. Now it was suddenly filling my head: Ela's short skirt; her braided hair; her cinnamon-candy mouth last night; the way she had thrown herself at me when she was a student; her professors and her peers undressing her as she stood on a platform playing her violin with passion, swinging her skirt and revealing just a little bit more of her thighs...until someone caught a glimpse of her white panties under her little skirt.

I tried to make myself think of anything else during the day. It wasn't as if there was nothing to think about: I had depositions to prepare for, clients to gently soothe, papers to review and shuffle all over my desk. But my mind stubbornly went from the numbers on a tax form to Ela, from a dry contract paragraph to Ela.

Always back to Ela.

Ela on campus, her dark hair shining in the autumnal sun. Ela's cheeks flushed with excitement and the prematurely chilly air, her thighs red with the cold, all the hormone-raging eighteen-year old boys turning to

watch her as she walked past them. Boys – thin and lanky with youth, fun and charming, unhindered by real worries, playing Frisbee in the courtyards, winking at Ela as she walked by. Shirts off, flirting with every move.

Asking for her number.

Boys who would be startled when she flashed a wedding ring on her hand – a small, gold band, no diamond, so as not to slow her nimble fingers while she played.

Cheap husband, they would think.

How old are you? they would ask.

And then the incredulity. *You don't look that old*, they would say.

And then the curiosity. *An older woman*, they would think. Because at their age, 27 seemed so very old.

A desire to see what time had done to a woman by that age (nothing, in Ela's case).

They would follow her, sniffing like dogs.

But Ela would skip away.

She had a way of dismissing boys like that, easily and with grace, that she had learned on the streets busking. Flirtatious, not dismissive. She would lower her eyes halfway and grin, shrug and wish them better luck next time. She was taken.

But it wasn't these boys who worried me, I had to admit.

A PhD in performance was going to consist of a lot of – and by this I mean *a lot* – of intense, one-on-one, intimate instruction with some professor. A man, most likely, because they always seemed to be men. An older man, a suave man, a man who was there to guide and mentor and encourage her. A man who had a reason to touch her, first on the wrist, then on the waist. Pressing lightly on her lower back. Tiny movements, tiny little touches to adjust her stance or her posture or her fingers.

That was how this kind of thing began.

In a small room, with a power dynamic, and some reason to lightly touch a woman's back and whisper instructions to her behind her neck, where his breath could brush over her and make her skin prickle with unexpected desire...

Letters and numbers swarmed in front of me, making no sense. I rubbed my eyes.

Focus Peter, Petie old boy.

Ela hated that kind of thing, I reminded myself.

Didn't she?

She would never allow herself to be such a cliché.

She had said so herself.

LA FOGATA
(8 YEARS EARLIER)

Ela and I couldn't be kept away from each other, and we hid our relationship (though probably poorly, for anyone who was looking closely) until the end of the semester. She was bright girl and I gave her an 89 on essay that deserved a real "A," just to cover our tracks. The grade made her grimace and then laugh.

I spent way too much time with Ela, at the end of my Master's degree, and produced what was probably the world's worst thesis. It didn't really matter: by then I was only finishing my program to be finished. I had already decided to go to law school, be a citizen, stay in the US permanently.

Ela was beautiful and young, and she seemed to adore me. But I was always leery of her love, as if it were too good to be true. I tried not to pick that particular bone with her: I didn't want to seem as desperate or as needy as I actually was. I wanted to constantly confirm with her, and hear her tell me over and over again, that she was mine.

At the same time, there was a perverse pleasure I got from bringing up her professors, her handsome, young friends. The members of her string quartet, who quite obviously salivated over her.

"You spend so much time with those guys, though," I suggested, one evening at *La Fogata*, a favorite Mexican restaurant of Ela's. (The mention of *La Fogata* made her squeal in pleasure and jump up and down in a chair shaking her tiny, balled-up fists in excitement. Consequently, *La Fogata* was a source of a great deal of debt for me.) "You never...get tempted?"

"Ugh," she said. "They're so....bearded. They listen to indie music and get uptight about their coffee." She cocked her head and tossed her silky hair over one shoulder. "I *only* like men who get uptight about their tea."

I smiled for her.

What she said should have been enough, but it never was. I bit down on my own tongue to stop myself from prying further: *But you stay at hotels together all the time...win things together, lose things together....you*

must feel some kind of camaraderie...late at night, you have some drinks, you don't ever think about...?

Ela dug into her food, unaware of my inner struggle.

A couple passed us, and Ela's attention was suddenly snatched away from her food.

Without knowing precisely what it was, I got enough of a glimpse of the couple to get the gist: the silver-haired man, in a corduroy blazer with patches on the elbows. The Asian girl with well-trimmed fingernails and very long, black hair. Young. Younger than Ela.

Music student. And professor. It was like they were wearing signs.

"Oh god," Ela said suddenly, placing her napkin over her mouth. She shook her head. "I think I have to go. I think my dinner is ruined." She closed her eyes and shook her head vigorously.

She was exaggerating, as Ela was wont to do, and I knew there was no way she was leaving her Fogata Special (a chili relleno stuffed inside a burrito and smothered in green chili) uneaten. Ela, a half-Spaniard raised in Arizona, was violently loyal to good Tex-Mex, and though no one had ever experimented with it, it was not hard to imagine her slitting someone's throat over a relleno.

Her eyes popped open and she craned her neck, though there was no way she could see the couple who had disturbed her so greatly, and she pressed her napkin more firmly to her mouth, now like she was holding back vomit.

"Oh god," she repeated.

I turned around and looked the way they had gone, knowing I wouldn't be able to see them in the next room, a cavernous, finer dining area with an actual *fogata*, where they served high-end Mexican food like chicken mole (which Ela wanted nothing to do with.)

She leaned forward and clamped her mouth on the straw that ended in a gigantic, fish-bowl sized margarita we were sharing. She squeezed her eyes shut as the frozen liquid gave her a brain-freeze. "Oh god," she said again, but his time because of the pain.

I turned back to her.

"I don't see what the big deal is," I ventured, not even sure what the situation was, other than what I had read from the appearance of the two who had passed us. "I mean...you and I are kind of..."

Ela shook her head furiously, as much at what I was saying, as to rid herself of the pain of the frozen margarita she had downed. She tossed her napkin away and leaned forward suddenly, her eyes lit up and glittering with her love of proving a point.

She held a finger up to stab at the air for each of her various points:

“I mean, I know we had a thing when...but it's different, you're like....born in the *same century* as me.” Stab. “And now, you're nobody, you know? Not my TA anymore, I mean.” Stab. “That guy...she is going to be stuck with him for like three years.” Stab. “And plus it's just so.....cliche.”

She fell back against the booth.

“Ugh. And he's like....65. He's married.” She stabbed at the air again. “She's *eighteen*. And it's...god, it's really just *such a fucking cliché*.”

She shook her head quickly. “Ugh. He's so *ugly*, too.”

I shrugged. “I hear some girls get off on that.”

Her face softened.

I was, in fact, the sort of ugly, nerdy man that girls seemed to like precisely because I was ugly. It had taken me a while to realize this was an actual thing, and that I was good-looking in a way because of the gargoyled nature of my features.

Ela's face softened and she leaned closer to me over the table. “Not ugly like you,” she whispered. “Not hot-ugly. *Ugly*.”

I shrugged again. “He didn't seem that bad.”

Ela threw her napkin at me, missed, and hit the man behind me in the back of the head.

I didn't turn around. I watched her cover her mouth and widen her eyes and turn on all of her sweet, Natalie Portman look-alikedness. “I'm so terribly sorry,” she mucked. “I meant to hit my boyfriend with that. I'm *so* bad at sports.”

I could feel the gaze of the man she had hit swerve onto me, hating me for being mean to a sweet girl like Ela, mean enough so that she threw a napkin at me.

Ela shook her head again. “She's such a bad violinist,” she mused. Then she shrugged, and reached for the margarita again. Suddenly brightened, she smiled. “It's probably the best thing for her, really.”

“So that's her...”

“Prof. Oh god. Ugh. Like, seriously, *every pretty girl* ends up banging some old fart like that. It's so sleazy.”

I twisted the straw in my fingertips. “*Every* pretty girl?”
Her eyes slammed into me and burned with her answer.
But Ela didn't know that I wanted to hear something else besides
“no.”. That I was intoxicated by the idea that she had maybe done
something naughty.

“You've never done that?” I continued.

Her eyes glowered at me over the margarita, but she finished sipping
before she replied. “*I* don't need to.” Her eyes flicked back at the adjacent
room and narrowed. “I'm a great violinist. I just don't understand
philosophy.”

Her comment was a good joke, and meant to wrap the whole
conversation up.

But it was eating away at me.

It was eating away at me because there was just a tiny bit of me, still,
that didn't quite believe Ela was as smitten with me as she claimed to be. A
tiny bit of me that actually enjoyed the painful thought of her using me
somehow – even though by now, there was really nothing I could offer her.
A tiny bit of me that liked hearing about her previous lovers, her previous
escapades.

“But you never even had a situation where...you know? You could
have furthered your career a little by...”

Her eyes were annoyed when they came back to mine. “*Every*
situation is pretty much like that in music,” she said. And then I could
almost see her face change as she read something in my face. She seemed to
get that there was more to my question than idle curiosity.

Her mouth turned up a little on one side.

But she waited for me to ask her for it.

So I went on: “You've never had some...what do you call it? Master
class? Where the guy is like, oh, Graciela, just hold your violin like this -”

“Wrong hand,” she quipped, making fun of my pantomime of a
professor wrapping himself around her, pressing himself up against her
small, hard body.

She laughed. Then her eyes dove into her burrito.

Guiltily.

She began to slice it into small pieces with her knife and fork.

“Oooohhhh,” I said, and a really delicious, really hot snake uncoiled
inside of me. “So there *was* something.”

Ela continued eating, and a silence draped the table for a long minute.

She waved a fork at me suddenly, and with her her mouth still full of burrito, declared: "It was not *my* fucking prof, though."

As if the universe were entirely against me, a cake shedding sparkles came by, followed by the restaurant's noisy mariachi band and a trail of waiters, clapping and singing a Mexican birthday song. It was Ela's perfect out: she turned to the racket as though it were the most interesting thing in the world, and I never did get to pry into this prof who had not been her prof, but who had been something.

Not that night.

And not really ever.

I knew from then on that she was hiding something, but it was never possible to get her to take it seriously. Never possible to get anything from her. Was he old? Was he young? Was he rich, fat, ugly, handsome? When had she done it? And why? Was he any good? Was he better than me?

Sometimes she rolled her eyes, sometimes she changed the subject.

Sometimes she turned it into a joke:

"With a prof? Yes. Oh, you've caught me. But not only was he a prof, he was a big, manly man, like Bruce Willis. In fact, he was once in the Mossad. Violin teacher was only his cover. He was actually a secret agent...a mercenary." And then, with a snort, because it was all so ridiculous: "And I was his muse."

BACK FROM SCHOOL

By five pm, on Ela's first day back to school, I could no longer restrain myself from calling her.

I took out my phone.

I mean, I was just being a good husband. Taking interest in my wife, and her life.

I knew there was more to it when I called, though; I knew what I actually wanted to hear about was not her *day* – not new girlfriends, or what the campus was like after all these years, or how great it felt to be doing something new. I wanted to hear about how many men had watched her ass as she bounced along, under the canopies of trees on her way to the music building. I wanted to hear how she had joined a group of young men for a cigarette and let them soak up her plunging neckline and bare legs while she placed her plump lips on someone's smoke, taking a drag, making him think of his own cock and how her lips would feel closing around his cock like they were closing on the filter.

I wanted to hear about her new instructors. How they had all asked to see her at the end of class, could she please come by the office? Close the door? *You know that coming back to do a PhD in performance after such a long time is a difficult task, maybe you aren't up to the challenge, maybe you need some extra attention...*

This is why my throat croaked when she answered the phone, and instead of saying *hi* or something normal, I made a froggish, incomprehensible noise.

“Hello to you, too. Yes, my first day was extraordinary. I am thrilled and all of my professors are hot, hot as a chili omelet on an Arizona sidewalk in July, as you predicted.” She let that sink in. “But seriously, I have to practice. Everyone has a lot of game. So do you want pizza or Thai tonight? Your choice, bring it home.”

A pause.

“You there?”

“Yeah...I...” I cleared my throat. “I was just...”

“Calling to see how my day was,” she said, cloyingly. “I know. Thank you. It was all of the above and now I really have to get to practicing so...*adios*.” She kissed the phone, pressing her lips to where the microphone was embedded and make a terrible slurping noise as she did.

Then silence.

I held my phone in my hand and stared at it.

What was wrong with me? I was infinitely dissatisfied with the conversation I just had with Ela, this much I knew.

But why?

There was nothing unusual in Ela's brusqueness on the phone. She was like this whenever she had something she wanted to accomplish, and there was no reason for me to think that she wasn't going to come home from her first day and have the drive to be better than everyone else, now that she had seen the competition. That was just how Ella was. It was what she did.

But had her voice seemed more dismissive than usual?

I shook my head, as though having a conversation with myself, where I could see myself and my own dismayed face. *Idiot*.

I was dissatisfied with Ela's dismissal of my fantasies, really. That she had said only that her professors were hot, but in a mocking voice, a voice that indicated she didn't really understand or care, or worse yet thought I was a little bit of a freak. A freak who wanted to hear about other men gawking at her. Other men being attracted to her.

Her being attracted to other men.

I tried to refocus my energy.

Ela hated pizza. I wondered why she had offered it as a choice. She was the only person on earth I had ever met who actually *hated* pizza. Not because it was unhealthy: this was a girl who ate the worst forms of fried Tex-Mex like it was her last day on earth if you let her anywhere near it. She just...hated pizza.

And Ela loved or hated things with bottomless passion.

I pushed the remark out of my mind, but still it bothered me.

I tried to keep my thoughts on clean things, like what Ela like to eat, but it all ended like a porno, with Ela placing a huge burrito in her mouth like an oversized cock, her lips stretching to accommodate it, her eyes batting flirtatiously.

My thoughts drifted back to her short gray skirt, and her “hot-as-Arizonan omelets” professors, their eyes moving from her slender feet to her ankle, up her sculpted calf, to her thighs, and then letting their imagination fill in all that they couldn't see, the shapes that filled out her clothing and the colors that lay underneath it. And Ela, a finger in her braid, smiling with false shyness. “*I'm your new student,*” she would say.

I decided on Thai. It was closer to home, it would require less time. I really wanted to be home, and I didn't want delve too much into why that was, within my own mind.

But I knew.

I wanted to see Ela. Make sure she was the same.

God, Peter, what in the hell is wrong with you?

What in the hell *was* wrong with me? I was obsessing about Ela, in ways I gave into only just before falling asleep.

Occasionally, the way I drank whiskey.

Now I was binging on thoughts of her being seduced. Thoughts of her seducing other men. Thoughts of swarms of men surrounding her and pawing at her until she simply couldn't resist...

I was at the Thai restaurant, my windshield wipers swiping away noisily at a wet, early autumn sludge that was falling from the sky. The heat was on to the point of making me ill, because I had cranked it up and forgotten it. I had stopped the car in a parallel parking spot without any memory of doing so.

My mind had been so absorbed by the thought of Ela swinging her hips through the hallways of the School of Music that I had driven all the way there and not even noticed.

When I got home the lights were still out, except for the light in an upstairs practice room for Ela. I could hear her violin outside, repeating and repeating a phrase of music.

Honestly, after a certain point, it all sounded the same to me. Good, clearly, and well beyond anything I could ever hope to do or imagine doing. But Ela's anger with some certain three seconds of notes, or her devastation after a concert about some place where she “cacked it,” were utter mysteries to me.

I opened the door, and then I slammed it, so that the house would shake and she would know I was home.

The phrase continued, uninterrupted and repeating.

I wasn't sure what to do so I stared at the clock.

After five minutes, the music stopped, and Ela's adorable, skittish footsteps pattered over the floor and down the stairs.

"Oh hey, sweetie."

She looked a little like she had been lightly exercising, which is a thing I think few people understand about playing an instrument unless they've been around a musician: it's a heck-ton of a workout. Ela is a quiet and reserved player, compared to some, but she really gets into it sometimes and her whole body moves.

"Thai?" she said, taking in the plastic bags on the counter. "Great. I'm starving."

I was a bit miffed, but of course I had no legitimate reason to be. Ela could not know that I had turned some weird corner in my life and was now obsessed with something I didn't fully understand myself. That I had spent the whole day thinking about her, that I imagined all afternoon the things she was doing with other men...but still, the casual way she grabbed the Thai food, as if it were any other day, was almost...*infuriating*.

"How was your day?" I said sweetly.

She ripped a box of noodles open and shoveled them into her mouth. "Terrible."

I waited.

"God, I was so hungry." Ela munched ravenously on her noodles.

I opened my own box calmly. My stomach was, for some reason, twisting: I wanted to hear details about her day, and I wanted those details to be something specific, something I wanted. I knew it was unreasonable, and a little crazy, but I couldn't stop myself.

"Terrible?" I repeated, robotically, not really understanding the word.

She looked at me and smiled derisively. "Yeah. Really, really awful. Don't sound so fucking cheerful about it."

I shook my head. "No, god, sorry..."

Ela interrupted me, suddenly flushed with real, genuine excitement, as if the noodles had brought her back from the dead.

"You already *asked me about this*. No, it's great. I think I told you I wouldn't be able to work with Mark Casalis? That I got my second choice? Well, something got shuffled because one of Mark's students bailed because of a visa problem, and so I'll be able to work with him from the start. Isn't

that great?" Ela was speaking so quickly her words were blending together, and her voice had acquired the lilting, valley-girl accent of most eighteen-year olds. Which was never something she had entirely lost, mind you – it was just so....*prevalent* now. She wound and wound her noodles around her fork in her excitement, and now she stuffed the whole fork, and the enormous pile of noodles, into her mouth and chewed furiously.

I searched for a good comment. "That's great, sweetie!" I said enthusiastically.

"This guy...did I tell you about him? I think I gave up after I thought he couldn't fit me in...but he's...."

Ela's words disappeared into a slush of musical terms and names of orchestras, and I tried to fixate on what she was saying, but my mind was awash in craziness.

Why so much craziness? I wondered.

I was being a psychopath.

My wife simply wanted to go back to school, to do her PhD, to be the talented musician she was and stand a chance of having her own real job, instead of running around playing shitty gigs. And I was being a psychopath who just wanted to hear about the men who were hitting on her.

Ela was blinking at me. Expectantly.

There wasn't much else to do here besides say *uh-huh, not really, or I can't remember*. Any of which were extremely risky.

"Really?" I said, taking a venturesome leap.

Ela's eyes closed, very slowly, and reopened, also very slowly. They were now on fire.

"You weren't listening to me."

Her voice was as cold as her eyes were superheated.

"I just..." I said, and my voice sounded helpless. "I don't understand all your musical mumbo-jumbo."

I used "mumbo-jumbo" because it was one of the few Americanisms left that eluded my native English tongue, came out awkward as a result, and usually entertained the hell out of Ela.

She sighed.

"I have to get back to practicing," she said, without amusement.

"Sweetie," I began. "I'm really sorry, I just...my mind is on other things. I have a big dep coming up, some really pesky clients, I'm sorry. I didn't mean to be..."

My voice trailed off. Ela was scrunching up her nose. “Just winding you up,” she said. “But I really do have to get back to practicing.”

She had warned me, when she began this path, that she would end up practicing six or eight hours a day. I hadn't really believed it. When I had first met her she had practiced a lot, but it had all been somewhere where I couldn't see her, or hear her. After I had graduated from my Master's program, she had gone to a program in Denmark and we had maintained a long-distance relationship. I had never really experienced her life as a music student.

Now, I listened to the door click and the plucking of strings, a pause, and then a musical phrase starting up, then halted, then started again, then halted, then slower, then halted. And I realized, I was probably not going to see much of my wife for a while.

No, it was probably just the first-day jitters. She was overcompensating, another habit of hers.

I reasoned with myself: I didn't see that much of her anyway because she usually had gigs on Friday nights. And Saturday nights.

It was all fine. I was not jealous. I was not going to be a dick. I had suggested that she return to school. I was just fine with all of it.

In reality, I didn't have much to do that night. Or that much on my mind from work.

What was on my mind was Ela. Her courses. The way she walked through campus to them, and the leering boys on the way.

Her professors.

Her peers.

What was wrong with me?

Ela gigged all the time with young guys. She stayed the night in some of the places they went to, she had been the violinist for a band called Clear Blue Wasteland for two years, and they had all been young, hipsterish, and away for days.

The same kinds of guys she was likely to run into at school now.

They were non-threatening somehow: their ultra-long beards, crappy clothes, whining metro-sexuality had not been particularly threatening.

They just weren't Ela's type.

Ela's type had to be a little more manly.

I knew I didn't precisely fit that bill, but I was, in Ela's words, just so ugly that I was attractive, in a manly way. And she forgave me any lack of true, American manliness because I was from the UK and she “had a thing for that.”

When Ela's eyes wandered, it was always to a guy who was distinctly different from her music crowd. Like her ex-boyfriend Christian Neilsen, the Danish soccer player she had dated during our “open relationship” while she studied in Denmark.

Christian was another story, a guy who kept me up at nights for another reason.

I returned to my current issue:

What was I worried about with these music students?

With her profs?

She wouldn't really sleep with a prof, would she?

But then she had. I knew she had, she had told me so. I had never been able to pry any details from her – it was one last, little secret she didn't reveal to me, but that I knew, I *knew* was true. There was some nugget of truth to what she had said at the Mexican restaurant so many years ago, no matter how much she tried to blow it off as a joke or not reveal any details to me.

But was this the only thing that was gnawing at me?

I lay awake staring at the ceiling. Listening to Ela practice.

You might be wondering, why it is that I had gone so utterly paranoid in just one day.

There were just a *few* other things.

THING #1

There was this:

It was an odd night. Ela had more than usual to drink, and we went to a party with a lot of grad student friends of mine from the Philosophy department.

The jokes about Ela and I had, by then, gotten old for most of my friends. We'd been dating for six months in the open, and we looked like the kind of couple that was going to stay together. When I had first brought her around, there had been a lot of ribbing, references to *Lolita* (which Ela had quickly dismantled as making, literally, no sense to anyone who had actually read the book), and requests to see Ela's ID.

It was summer, most of us were graduating, and the streets around campus were filled with swarming, shifting party-goers, moving from one house to the next. Our own group somehow merged with some music students.

For this crowd, Ela's TA love affair was apparently still a source of jokes.

But the jokes were strange.

It was something I thought about only later, later in the evening when Ela did the strange thing she did.

I overheard things, only half-listening. Snippets of conversations. Or maybe I saw things, in the corner of my eye:

"This is Peter.." Ela lowering her head in a slight nod, while a thin, raven-haired girl named Lucie followed her gaze and her lips, her mouth open to ask a question and cut short by Ela's narrowing eyes.

"Oh!" A sudden, too-sweet, too-knowing smile. "The philosophy TA."

Or:

In a whisper, behind me, "Which one is this?"

Or:

Raised eyebrows. The scraggly, former violist of the quartet raising a glass to me with a shrug.

Did I see these things? I don't know. Many years have come and gone, and memory is a tricky thing.

At the time, I know I didn't think about it. Ela was drunk and kept leaning against me. Her hair smelled like lavender and she had an apricot tube-top on, and when she leaned close to me I could gaze into the dark shadow between her breasts, and imagine my face there soon. She kissed me on the lips and did something unusual, biting me lightly. Her eyes were full of vibrant mischief.

We ended up in her apartment, and her roommate was gone. We had seen her leave with her boyfriend and knew she would not be back. Ela's energy was strange and much more sexual than usual.

She turned in my arms and threw her hands around my neck.

"Everyone is so *scandalized* that you were my TA," she said, out of the blue.

I slid my hands under her shirt. She had gotten me worked up all night, cozing up to me and pressing her lips to my neck, my lips, my throat.

"Too bad," I murmured, my fingertips reaching the underside of her perky tits and delighting in the slight dampness from her sweating, and the firmness of her flesh that I was just about to stroke, "there isn't anything particularly scandalous to that story."

She grinned. "It *is* too bad. Too bad that you didn't try to take advantage of me."

Her mouth was close to mine now. She had a strange energy about her suddenly, a lot like the first time we were together in the classroom. Since that day she had been more demure, much more willing to let me take the lead. Now she seemed to have a plan and want me to follow her.

"Too bad you didn't make me...you know....do more for my grades."

Idiotically, because I was so surprised by her strange behavior, I said:

"But you were already getting good -"

"Mmmm," she said. Or rather, she *purred*. "That would have been even better. You could have made me your sex slave just to get the same grades I would have gotten *anyway*."

Of course, this thought was as searingly delicious as it was morally repulsive, and so it quivered around in me, pulling me in several different directions before I *got* that she was only playing a game.

A very sexy game.

She moved a finger down my chest and flicked open a button of my shirt. She was mildly annoyed that I wasn't playing along, and I struggled to recuperate.

It's just hard, you know...to know if you're going...too far.

“What would you have me do,” she said, “if I wanted...I don't know...a 'B'?”

She was already answering for me, sliding down to her knees on the ground. With her eyes locked on mine, she unfastened my belt, and grinned as she unzipped my pants.

But then she waited, as though she had really asked a question she wanted an answer to, and I blinked for a moment before I caught up to the game.

I reached down, and pulled my cock, which was hard as a rock and practically swollen, out of my underwear. I held it for her, and then I used my other hand to grasp her head. “If you wanted a 'B', you would have to be a very good girl,” I said.

And she smiled. She opened her mouth and let me push her head onto my cock. She kept her eyes lifted, and looked at me, as my cock went deeper and deeper into her mouth. Not wanting to gag her, I began to move her head up and down my shaft.

Her mouth was hot and wet, and her cheeks hollowed as she sucked my cock. I gasped at the sensation, and looked skyward. When I looked down she was still gazing up at me, and my hand was still on her hair. She lifted her head to pull my cock from her mouth, and now I was so hard that it remained, pointed straight to her face.

She licked around the hole, making a little circle as she asked her next question.

“And for an 'A'?”

I sucked in my breath. She smiled at me, and I knew I had the green light. She opened her mouth again, and then I pushed her down, down all the way to the base of my cock.

This is all I had meant. In truth, this would have been more than enough to make me give her an “A,” had we really been negotiating. My cock was enveloped in the soft, heated silk of her mouth, all the way to the base. It would only take just a little motion to make me come.

I started to tug on her hair, to pull her up and then push her down on my shaft.

She resisted, and I was confused. But then, incredibly, she began to do a thing I had never felt before:

She began to move the muscles of her throat, massaging the length of my cock inside of her. She squeezed and swallowed around my shaft, and the muscular ripples stroked me while the sounds of her gagging and the sight of her eyes watering in complete submission, for my pleasure, for her imaginary A, reached my brain and it was over in little more than ten seconds. I tried to pull away from her mouth as I felt my cum surging up, but she remained as she was, my cock clamped in her juicy, wet mouth. And then her throat and her mouth were filled with my cream, and it burst out of the side of her cheeks, between her skin and my pulsing cock. It dribbled down her face, but the rest she swallowed, her mouth still massaging my cock.

She reached up and grasped my shaft at the base, and then slowly pulled her mouth from me, licking up all of the sticky cum from my cock as she went. Her eyes had dropped to my cock now, and she watched it with great interest as she slurped up my cum.

Then her eyes fluttered up to meet mine. She was glassy-eyed and quite drunk, smiling, licking her lips.

“Was that good enough for an 'A'?”

A smarter man might have said no, and seen what else he could get her to do.

I just nodded, still in utter shock from having gotten the best and the filthiest blowjob of my life, from the sweet-faced little violinist student I had fucked in a classroom.

After that incident, she collapsed on the bed, and we fell asleep.

In the morning, I told her that was a lot of fun, and she held her head as though she was trying to remember. In a strange voice, she said, “Good.”

She kissed me.

And that was that.

She never repeated that particular fantasy. Not even drunk. And so I have been left to wonder, late at night, about all of it. How much did she like her fantasy of trading grades for sex? And did she have another TA, one who her friends had seen? Had she perhaps enacted her fantasy with him, for real? Why did her friends feel the need to say “philosophy” in front of the word TA, as if I needed some other title to distinguish me? Perhaps from

someone else, someone else that Ela maybe played a more realistic game with?

But we went on to date seriously, to get married, and I was left only to wonder about these things because...well, honestly, Ela was pretty good at steering a conversation in her own direction.

And maybe I didn't want to know. Maybe I just wanted to think about it late at night.

THING #2

There was also this:

After I graduated, I went to law school in Chicago, which was one and a half hours away by plane. We kept up our relationship all through the first two years, but then Ela decided to go study with a violinist at the Royal Danish Academy

By then, our long-distance relationship was getting taxed by...well, distance. I was frazzled by the amount of work in law school, nothing more. Ela was frequently unable to answer the phone, or out with friends. When we did speak, she seemed distant. There was something about the extreme time difference, the being in two different countries, the living in two different worlds, that divided us in ways that Chicago had not.

And particularly troubling, of course, especially for me, was that I couldn't have sex nearly every weekend.

We decided to have an open relationship while Ela was in Denmark. Decided.

The conversation about it got strange, and I found myself suggesting the idea almost vengefully. I had grown tired of Ela's yammering on about weird things in Denmark, her not answering the phone every time I called, the fact that she was often sleepy and just getting out of bed at ten when I called. She was smoking pot with her friends and seemed to be having a great time, whereas I was miserable, lonely, and overworked.

Tell you what, Ela, I remember saying. Maybe we just need to give each other permission to...you know, see other people while you're there.

It was one of those mornings that Ela seemed foggy, maybe stoned, maybe just sleepier than usual. She was laconic and her voice sounded sticky. When she answered me she seemed to be completely indifferent.

Is that what you want?

She didn't yawn, but she might as well have.

Her indifference raked through me, cold and hot, erotic and anger-inducing. I felt my cheeks color with that particular kind of male rage that is both desirous and murderous.

I think it's for the best, I said coolly.

I didn't of course. I wanted Ela to start crying, and for her to ask me if I was seeing someone else and that was why I was saying such a thing. I wanted her to be shocked.

Do you think that kind of thing actually works? she said, instead.

I had derailed now. I couldn't backtrack on what I had suggested. Now I had to go with it, and as I spoke, my mind was racing ahead to all the possible outcomes of what I had just set in motion. Some of them were enticing, uncurling in my chest, hot fingers of pain squeezing at me. Some of them were terrible, like Ela falling in love with some other man, dragging me along not wanting to hurt my feelings and then finally coming clean, leaving me at an airport.

I think it can work if we promise to be honest with each other. My voice was calm, as if this were something I had given a lot of thought to.

There was a silence, and hope fluttered inside of me that silent tears were sliding down Ela's face, and that any second I would hear a sniffle and she would tell me she didn't like this idea at all. That she didn't want to share me with anyone, and that she certainly had no interest in any man but me.

Ughhh, she said. I'm so tired. Let's...it sounds like you've thought this out though. So walk me through your ground rules.

And just like that, I had boxed myself into an open relationship. I delivered the “ground rules” as though I had spent a great deal of time thinking them through, an easy task for my nimble, law-school mind. I was used to thinking on my feet and spitting out contractual obligations in garbled legalese.

We tell each other everything.

We tell each other if we start having an emotional connection to the other person.

It's just for fun.

We try to come back together in our own relationship afterward.

We tell the people we date that we are in a committed but open relationship.

Complete transparency.

Ela yawned, for real this time.

It sounds good. I'm so tired now. Let me sleep on it.

A pause.

Peter?

Yes?

You didn't have anyone in mind already, did you?

I didn't answer right away.

No.

You'd think Ela would have said, 'me either.'

But she didn't.

One week later she told me about Christian. A soccer player, a dark blond, brown-eyed Dane who was tall, athletic, and flirted constantly with her. He was perfect, she said, because there was no way she would ever become emotionally attached to a jock.

What do you like about him?

I listened as though she were dripping opium onto my tongue, filling my veins with drop after drop of heroine, blowing cocaine through my nose. In reality she probably said only one sentence, but my memory tricks me, as though she had spent an hour telling me all about Christian, describing his male virility, his tan skin dripping with sweat, his biceps and chest carved into sharp, stone-like muscle, his stamina...

What she probably said, in reality, is 'oh, he's kind of sexy.'

I've likely taken my later memories, put them together with what I later saw, and created a memory of Ela droning on and on, over the phone, in her sexy voice, about Christian the soccer player, who she thought was perfect because he was sexy, and she could use him for sex without becoming attached.

The deal, as I had envisioned it, would be to have *complete* transparency.

I wanted Ela not only to tell me *when* she fucked this guy, but I wanted details.

At first I thought I merely wanted *some* details. Like, where they had done it, how good he was, and if she had liked it.

She had called me to check, to verify that in fact it was okay for her to go through with it, and actually have sex with him.

I think tonight's the night, she had said. *It's still okay, right?*

I had given her the green light.

All day, eight hours behind her, wondering what she was doing. If they had gone to some party (did Danes have parties?) and stood around, only seeing each other, until they had gone home, drunk and horny, and slammed against the walls of his apartment until they were naked on the floor, writhing like snakes. If he had made her some kind of candle-lit dinner, and smoothly seduced her, rubbing her small feet on a couch by a fire.

When she told me about it, though, it had been a walk along the canals, a weird Danish pastry, a few beers at a bar, and then she had gone home with him.

And?!!!! I remember wanting to scream.

So what happened? I said, instead, my voice calm.

I mean...yeah. It was okay. You know...first time.

Was he good?

Ela sighed. *I guess so, yeah. I mean...yeah. He's fun.*

As I listened to her, in the middle of the night, early in her morning, I realized I didn't want to hear anything like this.

I wanted to know how big his cock was. I wanted to know if she had come, and how many times, and if she screamed while she did it. I wanted to know if she had licked the length of his cock, and I wanted to imagine it all while she told me about it in vivid detail.

Tell me what happened.

There was a pause.

Look, okay Peter – here's the thing, I don't actually feel like giving you all the details, okay? I know we said honesty, and I'm being honest, I'm telling you what happened and how I feel about it. But I'm not going to say, like...exactly what happened. That's too much. It's too... you know. Private.

I told her it was fine.

But it wasn't.

Three months later, I was on a plane to Copenhagen with a freshly-issued passport and a cluttered, slow-moving mind. I had requested early tests, crammed for them, and left for Copenhagen without telling Ela.

This was a long-term plan of craziness, not the spur-of-the-moment idea I claimed it was when I finally saw Ela. She has never confronted me about it, not in all our years of marriage. But she must have known I needed time to get a passport, to arrange my tests to be taken early. Surely she

realized all of that as soon as she finally saw me, and I claimed to have wanted to surprise her.

I may have told myself that's what I wanted to do.

But it isn't what I did.

Not at first.

It's hard to know, now, if what happened was merely opportunistic, or if it is what I had planned all along. There's a great need for distinction between premeditation and opportunism in the law, and so it's a thing I ponder when I look back on what happened in Copenhagen. Did I plan to do what I did, all along? Or was it just chance?

Like most things, I suspect it was a combination of both.

I arrived on an early-morning flight. I was bleary-eyed and probably still drunk. It had been very easy to try and keep a lid on my agitation by slamming drink after drink on the plane.

I took a train from the airport downtown, after stashing my luggage. The place was dreadful, dreary. Gray skies barely mustered light when the sun came up, and the harbor looked like a slick of oil.

I arrived at her apartment after giving up on figuring out the public transportation system in my semi-drunk state, and hailing a cab. The building was a large apartment complex, boring and typical of Europe. Bland stucco covered a large rectangle with hundreds of big, rectangular eyes and no window coverings.

I realized, as I stood in front of the building, that I had no plan. No key, no idea if Ela would even be there.

The door to the building was, as most things are in Denmark, wide open. I found the apartment and stood in front of the door, my hand in the air, ready to knock.

But something stopped me.

I backed away from the door.

Here is where I realized: I wasn't just here to see Ela. If I had been, I would have knocked on the door. But I didn't.

I stepped backward, and then I turned quickly on the stairs, nearly running by the time I got to the bottom of them, in case she came to the door and opened it.

Outside, I squinted into the gray but strangely bright day. I started formulating my plan. Where I could hide. Where I could keep watch on Ela's apartment.

My stomach snarled at me.

I struggled to remember her schedule. She had class at ten in the morning. I had plenty of time to look for something to eat, and be back here, waiting, sitting on a bench in the small park across the street.

I even bought some bread, and tore it into pieces to feed the pigeons. It was a great disguise, because that's the last thing I would have done in real life. I hate pigeons.

And so I ate a weird pastry from a convenience store a block away, drank a weak and tasteless coffee from a coffee shop next door, and sat, wrapped in my trench coat and shivering, feeding pigeons in the park. My eyes on the door of Ela's apartment. My next move completely unknown. Would I stalk my own girlfriend all day? And why? To find out what? What I already knew?

While I sat on the bench I imagined the pain I would feel if she emerged with her Danish soccer player. If they came out and he pulled her close to him with his big, athletic hand wrapped around her slender neck, his tongue filling her mouth and devouring her lips. If he whispered something in her ear, something about her hot cunt and how it was filled with his seed...

While I thought these thoughts, my cock got harder and harder, and it was difficult to explain, even to myself, why that was so. Why I wanted to imagine it over and over, and why my mind went off to a fantasy where I crossed the street after the two of them parted ways, and grabbed Ela in a passionate embrace, so that I could slide my hand between her jeans and her skin and find the warm, wet evidence of her full betrayal, dripping between her thighs.

But Ela emerged alone, about an hour later, and my heart leaped in my chest. It was a leap of relief and disappointment, and the joy of seeing her. Her hair was loose, already longer, hanging from a red wool cap and blowing in the wind. She had her violin case strung over one shoulder. Her cheeks were pink, her lips were red like her cap, and she wore a tight-fitting, short jacket that showed off her dancer-like figure. She skipped down the steps.

I followed her.

She walked all the way to school, quite a long way. She never turned around. Sometimes I had a scare, when she stopped to pet a dog, or to look

at some flowers, or to buy a croissant. It burned me that she was so chipper, so content, so far away from me.

When she disappeared into the conservatory, I stood outside, my hands in the pockets of my trench coat. I needed a plan.

And so I actually followed her all day. From the conservatory to another building, where she stayed for a very long time. She emerged with several people, and they stood on the steps a while, chatting.

And then, one by one, they dribbled away, hands raised in goodbyes. I was about a hundred yards away on the veranda of another building.

Then it was just Ela, her hands in her pockets, her foot against a banister on the steps. She tossed her hair flirtatiously.

Ela, and a tall, young man, with dirty-blond hair and a square jaw. An athletic build underneath a thin Nordic jacket. They were smiling at each other, moving closer to each other. Teasing each other.

And then Ela reached out and took his hand. He jerked her close to him, and I heard her peal of laughter all the way across the courtyard.

It cut through me like a knife.

He put his hand up to her face, pushing strands of her brown hair from her eyes. His mouth was moving.

Saying the things men say when they want a pretty girl like Ela to go home with them, and open her legs up so he can get inside of her sweet flesh.

He grabbed her, and dipped her, holding her body easily with one strong arm as he pushed more hair from her face. His fingers ran over her skin, over her cheekbones and her lips.

And then he picked her up, while she screamed and laughed. Picked her up with incredible ease, and threw her over his shoulder.

Ela made a show of kicking, but not for real. She squealed delightfully, and across the courtyard her voice screamed, "Christian!"

Cris-ti-ahn.

I closed my eyes. The sensation that went through me was so intense I couldn't tell what it was, like water that is either superheated or supercooled, and you don't know which it is because it burns either way.

He set her down about three hundred yards later, and they held hands and bounced against each other, all the way to *Ela's* apartment.

What I did next is the part that is most easily defined as opportunistic. There is no way I could have planned for it, you see. For all of it to fall in line the way it did.

I skipped up the steps behind them, and paused at the bottom of the building while they flirted, talked about someone in Ela's classes, laughed, kissed, and Ela fumbled with the keys.

And then, with no idea what would await me inside the apartment, I ran up the steps as the door began to swing closed.

Anything could have happened here. It could have been an open-concept floor plan, and I might have stepped right into a big room where there was no place to hide. How would I have explained myself then, I often wonder?

I could have walked right into them. Or Ela could have noticed that the door did not click shut. She could have seen my fingers around the frame. Christian could have seen the same thing and smashed my hand in.

The apartment could have lacked all of the labyrinthine halls that were actually inside of it. It could have had squeaky floors.

All of these things could have happened, but none of them did. I placed my hand on the door and let it close almost completely, but not fully. I listened as their voices lowered, and disappeared into the apartment. I opened the door and found myself in a narrow hallway, with Ela's stuff, including a bicycle and several violin cases, crowding the floor.

There was a closet at the end of the hallway, and several rooms leading off the hall. One was a kitchen, I could tell, and the other a bathroom, and then there appeared to be two rooms. My mind raced. They were in one of the two rooms, and they were laughing and whispering.

My eyes scanned my options, which weren't many. In the hallway I had no place to hide. The bathroom was almost surely a very small, continental affair with the shower hanging next to the toilet and the whole place serving as a shower stall.

In the next room, things were getting heated, and I wanted to see them. I wanted desperately to see what for now I could only hear: their lips meeting and smacking as they pulled apart and met again. The rustling of clothing being removed, of hands on smooth, dry skin that would soon become sticky and sweaty.

Fuck.

I moved a few steps forward. My heart was pounding, because if anyone came out of that room – say Ela, too pee, as she often did – then I would just be a crazed man, in the middle of a hallway, and there was nothing, nothing at all I could possibly say to cover it up. I was standing there like burglar, stiff like a guilty thief. With an erection that was pressing my trousers out like a circus tent.

Their bodies seemed to come closer to the hall. In both a blind panic and very tunnel-vision moment, I stepped in two gigantic, careful steps, toward the closet, turned the handle, and opened it. Praying silently that it didn't simply end in shelves.

The scent of Ela's clothes wafted past my nose, and they swung slightly in front of me on their hangers. The bodies were coming closer to the door behind me, closer to the hall. "I have to pee," I heard Ela say.

I dove into the clothing and pulled the door shut behind me with my hand behind my back.

For a moment I was suffocating on the clothes, and my arm began to ache immediately from the way it was twisted behind me, but I had to hold it to keep my balance and to keep the door closed. I waited with my breath still in my chest and pain shooting down my arm, trying to assess where I was and whether there was a wall.

But after a moment it became clear that in front of me, between the many shirts and jackets of Ela's, there was a cool blue light. I blinked.

A curtain.

My arm screamed at me. I used my right arm to feel ahead of me, seeking a wall to support myself so I could let the handle slowly twist back into place. I heard Ela through the wall to my right, sitting on the toilet, a trickle of pee hitting the bowl.

A pang of jealousy hit me again. She always did this before having sex with me, too.

My right hand found a wall and I pushed on it gingerly, fearing it would be a false wall or part of a closet organizer. But no, it was solid. With just enough lateral pressure I could relieve the support that was hanging on the handle entirely. I moved slowly, pain racking every move, my hand going numb behind me, my right arm getting sore from supporting myself. Until, finally, I was freed from the handle behind me. I sat down on my knees.

One below the shirts, I could see through to the other side of the closet. It ended with a curtain, and suddenly I both understood and could not believe my good fortune. The curtain led to another room, where maybe I could sneak around and see them.

But then, suddenly, I heard the voice of Christian. So close it almost shocked me.

“Come here.”

His voice had lost all of the cheerful, flirtatious pretense it had until that moment. No it was commanding, and assured. The kind of voice that people only have when they know that they will get what they want. That they will say things like *come here* and people will.

A small explosion took place inside of me, and cold, delicious fear and lust spread out through me and slammed into my balls.

I was right here.

I was going to get to see them, together.

My heart seemed to travel around my body, feeling like a block of ice. My cock was getting hard, I could feel that. And with it, then, had to come the recognition that I *wanted* to see this. The fact that I stayed on the floor, trying to slow my breath and not give myself away was proof of my desire. My skin tingled with excitement, there in the semi-darkness, only a curtain between me and the two people who had gone silent and were now perhaps touching each other, or looking at each other in those moments just before animal lust takes over.

My girlfriend, sweet Ela, and this Danish hunk.

I shivered and reached toward the curtain.

How could I move it without it being noticed? I was afraid to shift my weight, afraid I might fall or knock over one of the many precariously perched items Ela had crammed into the closet. The closet smelled like her: her perfume, her clothes, all of her most plain and innocent smells.

I leaned forward and used my fingertips to move the curtain just a hair.

Right before me, bare now, but unmistakable, was Ela's calf.

Only a flash of it, as she moved toward wherever she had been beckoned. I could hear them breathing, I heard the dull thump of clothing falling to the floor.

I heard Ela murmur, and I imagined her taking in the soccer player's full physique, her eyes lighting up in pleasure.

Brazenly, I pulled on the curtain to crane my neck and get a better view.

It was fine. No one in the room was paying any more attention to curtains or windows or anything but each other.

The Dane was naked, standing in front of Ela, who had stripped to just her underwear. He had a golden tan that ended at his waist and began again at his knees, and the wiry, muscled thinness of an athlete who runs. His arms were sculpted like his thighs. And between his legs, his cock – uncircumcised, fat, and long, was pointing directly at Ela.

She reached out and ran her hand, her palm open, over the smooth knob at the end, pushed out from his foreskin by his incredible hardness. His cock twitched as she made a circle over him with her palm. I heard her giggle.

He reached out and began to slide her panties down her hips. They were a black, silky pair, a pair she had obviously chosen deliberately, with the intent of having him see them first. They clung to her hips just below the sweet curves of her hip bones, and plunged in a v-shape inward, barely covering in lace and satin the sweet place where her body opened up into pink, hot delights.

He pushed her onto the bed suddenly, looking down at her with intense lust. There was nothing silly in this encounter: he was going to have his way with her, and that could be seen on his face.

Ela's hair swung behind her shoulders – she had evidently expected to be tossed around like a toy, and had caught herself on her elbows. What did her face look like right now, I wondered? Probably inviting. Surly, a little. Challenging him to do his worst, because she liked it.

My heart plunged to the floor.

Painfully, I rose to my feet. My calves were going numb, and I wanted to see better. I had to move slowly to avoid an accident, or making any noise. My thighs burned as I did so, but I was so hooked on what I was seeing that I just carried on, rising up until I could see Ela, naked except for her bra, stretching like a feline on the bed.

“Spread your legs for me.” Christian moved around the bed, so that his back was to me now. Ela followed him, scooting her legs to his end of the bed.

His accent was strong now. His eyes were glued to Ela's body on the bed.

I watched, with a blend of betrayal, anger, confusion, and horror, as Ela did exactly as she was told. She placed her hands on her thighs and pulled her legs apart and up, spreading them wide and revealing...

I squinted.

Revealing...her bare, fully smooth pussy. Completely shaved, nothing hiding the pink, wet slit of her cunt from view. I hadn't seen this before.

I could almost feel her soft pussy on my palm, nothing but smoothness as I dipped into her.

Except it wouldn't be me who would do that.

I stared at the firm buttocks of the man in front of me.

It would be Christian.

Even worse than her hands pulling her thighs apart was this: Ela's mouth was open in a wide, inviting smile. She opened her mouth opened wider and her lips formed a knowing grin.

She knew what he was going to do to her, whatever it was: and she liked it.

Ela, the girl I loved. The girl with whom I had loving, sweet sex with the occasional naughty moment.

Spreading her legs like a whore in a porno. Letting this guy talk to her like a five-dollar whore.

And *smiling* about it.

My mind was reeling. I stopped breathing, as jealousy and disbelief spread out in my abdomen like liquid nitrogen.

Ela stroked her thighs, inviting him closer.

"Spread them very wider," he said, in his ever-cruder English.

Ela's legs spread open she held herself now by the ankles. I could see her bare cunt, and the petals glistening between the folds of her labia. All of it spread open and waiting for *him*.

Christian climbed on to the bed. He jerked her bra up, sliding it up her arms to her wrists. She released her ankles and her legs floundered a little in the air. He slapped her on the thigh, near her ass, and a crack reverberated in the room. "Keep your feet up," he snarled.

And Ela, sweet Ela, obeyed. Her legs rose in the air to where they had been suspended. Spread open wide and high, just like he liked it. A pink mark was deepening in color on her thigh where he had smacked her.

He twisted her bra around her wrists and bound her hands.

I watched Ela's face as he hung her twisted hands on the bedpost. She smiled.

Christian moved his wiry hands to either side of Ela's ribcage, his thumbs turned inward to stroke her long nipples into hard little balls. She moaned and her body writhed beneath him.

My eyes were stinging. My heart was being shredded into a million pieces.

But my cock was hard, dripping precum. I couldn't tear my eyes away from Ela as her body was prodded and touched by another man, and I couldn't wait for what came next, when he would stretch her and pull her apart, splatter her with cum, fill her up and make her wet and dirty.

He didn't waste any time. He moved down her body with his mouth, leaving a glistening trail of his wet spit on her skin. He sat back on his heels and surveyed her spread legs and the bare cunt between them.

He reached down and fingered her labia, rubbing his finger over the baby-smooth skin. He pulled her lip away from the pink, engorged flesh it covered, almost as though showing her to me. I could see the bright, wet pink of her pussy, already wet and craving his touch.

He started in on her. He placed a fingertip on her clit and stroked it lightly, while Ela twisted in his hands and mewled like a cat.

Christian stared down at her, calming her into submission with only his gaze. "Stay still," he growled.

She lowered her hips and spread her legs, obeying his command.

Christian parted her petals one by one, feeling each layer of her and holding her soft, wet skin between his fingers, smiling as he felt her silky wetness.

My breathing was ragged now and the pain in my chest was almost intolerable. I could feel the precum of my erection dampening the whole front of my trousers. I found myself, inexplicably, rooting for Christian's filthy mind, hoping he would do something much dirtier than just this. I licked my lips.

He toyed with her clit, making circles on it with his forefinger while she struggled to stay still enough for him to touch her. Her muscles contracted and twisted beneath her skin, and her breath came in ragged puffs from her mouth.

I watched as Christian dipped his finger into her pussy. He glided into her. She was so wet I could see her juices glistening on her inner thighs,

dripping down to the sheets. He put another finger in, and the two fingers, veined with his athletic strength, moved in and out of her, tantalizing me with the prospect of a cock doing the same.

But he wasn't going there just yet. He slipped in another finger.

And then another.

My mouth opened involuntarily as I took in the sight. This man was going to *fist* her.

With this fourth finger, he elicited a howl from Ela, and her legs kicked inward. "Oh god," she panted.

He smiled at her, watching his hand as he pushed, with obvious resistance, into her pussy. My eyes widened as the inner lips of her cunt turned white with the strain of his hand – he was *fisting her* after all – and he kept disappearing into her.

"Does it hurt?"

Ela howled.

"Put your legs up."

He shoved into her hard, as he said this, and his hand moved several inches against Ela's tight cunt.

But she raised her legs, back to the position he wanted her in: legs spread, complete submission to him.

She began to moan, and it was as much in pain as in pleasure.

"That's it," he coaxed her.

"It hurts," Ela complained. But he didn't relent, and she didn't fight him: she just whined as he disappeared into her and began to fuck her with his hand. She kept her legs spread obediently.

He clawed upward with his hand inside of her, squeezing her from the inside. She howled, and her legs started to tremble.

Christian pulled his fingers from inside of her, after fucking her for a moment more. He lifted his hand to his face, and breathed in the scent of her pussy.

I looked at Ela on the bed, writhing carefully in her bondage so as not to unravel it. She was completely exposed to him, and to me. Her pussy was distended and drenched, the petals of her flower crumpled and swollen. But she held her legs for him, wide open for whatever he might do to her next.

My chest tightened I watched the fit, Danish soccer player hover above her for a moment, looking over body, deciding what he would do next. He leaned in, letting his mouth hover over her bare cunt without

touching her. She writhed beneath him, and I could see that she was eager to feel his tongue on her rawest part.

He extended his tongue and toyed with her, lapping with feathery touches at her swollen clit. Ela's body tensed and twisted. She squeaked, and then growled; panted and whimpered like an animal. The sounds were outside of her own control, it was easy to hear. There was no fakery in her moans, just to placate her lover. He was driving her wild with his tongue on her clit and she could barely take it.

I could see her climax rising like a tide. Her muscles were stiffening and her legs were trembling so wildly that her feet were flapping in the air, but still she held her legs open wide for him.

He lifted his head.

Ela howled in disappointment, and the disappointment cut through me as well. She panted, tossing her head back, and moaned again.

Evidently this kind of torture was not new to her: she was not confused by the interruption, only sweetly agonized by it. Her stomach rippled and she twisted against her restraints.

She panted the word *please* as he brushed his fingers over her dripping cunt. He flicked a finger at her clit, and it snapped in the air. She squeaked. He flicked her again, teasing her, punishing her.

"I want you to do something for me now. If you want to come."

I shivered with delight, imagining what it would be. My mind raced ahead to when I would see Ela's mouth wrapped around Christian's cock, his hand on the back of her head, pushing and pushing all of the thick, veined inches of his dick into her throat.

Ela threw her head back and moaned.

"What will you do for me?" Christian asked her, as though clarifying something she had said.

Ela lifted her head, and looked at him. I was shocked by her next submissive, whining plea:

"Anything," she panted. "Anything you want."

A smirk spread across Christian's lips, and he leaned close to her ear. His mouth moved to tell her what he wanted, and his lips nibbled on her ear, making her squirm.

Ela's eyes widened. "I don't think-"

He pressed his finger to her lips, and she sucked on it. "You can do it. And you must."

His wacky English, even, didn't ruin the mood. Ela's body stiffened and my cock throbbed as I wondered what he would get from her now. What dirty thing he had asked her to do that was so close to over the line for Ela that, unlike everything I had just seen, she dared to protest.

His hands moved to her wrists and freed her from her bondage, then ran over her body as she flipped onto her stomach.

"On your hands and knees," his low voice grumbled

I watched as Ela's body moved into the position he wanted.

A little doggie style. I looked at her dripping cunt, and watched as his thick cock grazed her opening.

He grasped her hair, then, and pushed her head down and onto the sheets. I knew that she couldn't see me, but her eyes seemed to meet mine, suddenly gleaming with fear. Her fingers came to her mouth, and she touched her lips. Christian's hand was still wound in her hair, pushing her into the sheets.

I licked my lips, because they were very dry. I unzipped my zipper, one tooth at a time, needing to hold my heavy cock in my hand. Even as I did this, I felt shame wash over me. I should stop this, whatever it was...but I couldn't. I didn't want to, but I also just *couldn't*. It was all too far gone now.

Christian dipped each of his fingers in her pussy. She whined and gasped, clenching the sheets.

Then he knelt forward, and licked her. He started at her clit, the red button so engorged it protruded from her bare lips (God, that was still driving me wild).

Then his tongue moved up. It trailed along her bare, hairless skin in an agonizingly slow line.

Ela grasped the sheets in fistfuls, stuffing them into her mouth.

"I don't know," Ela moaned. "I don't think I can..."

But she remained as she was, her ass to him, her face to the bed. Resisting only in word and not by moving. She was going to give him whatever it was he wanted -

I knew, suddenly, where his tongue was going. I wanted to look away but I could not.

I watched as he moved up, until he was trailing his tongue in circles around her dull pink anus.

Surely this would be too much for Ela.

Her eyes closed and squeezed shut, but she did not resist any more than that.

“Oh god,” she said. She let him lick at her and tease her.

He slowly worked his tongue into her, and a screech escaped from deep inside of her. A pleased, lusty screech. Sure to be one of agony soon.

I found my mind delighting in the prospect of seeing Ela take this guy's huge cock in her ass.

What in the hell, Peter?

What in the hell, indeed. My own cock was twitching wildly in my hand. I wanted it now. I wasn't sure exactly why, but I want to see her asshole spread open and watch her face as she took a big cock in her tiniest hole.

Christian sat back on his ankles, and moved a finger around Ela's wet asshole. It was ever-so-slightly opened. It pulsed with excitement, and probably the anticipation of pain.

Christian fanned his fingers. He pressed his pointer finger to the dark center of her asshole, and Ela sucked in her breath as it plunged inside of her. Not slowly; very quickly. He plunged one finger in her ass, one in her pussy, and rubbed his ring finger against her clit.

She whimpered and closed her eyes. 'I don't think I can,' she said. “Oh god, it hurts.” Her ass bobbed up and down, and she opened her mouth to breathe and bite the sheets around her.

“You can,” he assured her, and pushed his hand against her, his finger sinking deeper inside of her.

He pressed another hand against the small of her back. “Just relax,” he said.

He calmed her there, and it took almost a minute. Ela trembled and tensed, and then finally, finally, lay down to a relaxed pose, panting on the sheets.

“I want to get my cock wet before I fuck your ass.”

Now that he said it, it sent a sharp jolt through me. All along I had known that's what he wanted, but I had expected Ela to stop him, truthfully.

“Oh, god” Ela howled, but she did nothing to stop him. She writhed and sucked in her breath again, and her asshole clamped tightly on the finger still inside of her.

“Relax,” he coaxed.

He used his other hand to lift his fat, veined member. He slipped his cock into her engorged slit, and I saw a gush of her sweet juices spill out, sliding down to coat his balls. He pressed down again on the small of her back and pushed her lightly back and forth, using her like a meat puppet to stroke his cock. Ela bristled with new desire, and I remembered then how close she had been to coming.

“Fuck me,” she whispered. “Oh please fuck me until I come.”

I raised my eyebrows. This was *not* Ela. She never talked like this, so dirtily, not in all the time I had been fucking her.

“I will,” Christian responded, coolly. He was moving her almost clinically now, trying to work her up to the point he wanted to get her to: his cock in her ass.

His finger was still inside of her asshole, and I imagined how it must feel: hot and tight. How he must have been imagining his cock there, in only a matter of moments, being squeezed by the squealing, panting Ela.

His face was contorted and he was bursting at the tip of his cock. Of course he was, he was balls-deep in all of that very wet, very pink, very hot flesh, and she was pushing her ass back toward him for more.

Christian let her beg and moan like this for several minutes. He pulled his cock from inside of her and stroked her clit with the tip of his dick. He slid his finger from inside her ass and she yelled in pain.

Ela's eyes watered up in frustration and disappointment, and her long, brown lashes grew wet and sticky.

“Oh please,” she begged. “Oh please, please, please.”

He ignored her pleas, and from her clit, he guided his cock up to her ass. He pressed his tip to the pink entranceway.

“No, I can't,” Ela moaned. “No...I can't. I've never done that before.”

But she wasn't moving away, and neither was he. The blunt end of his cock was pressed against her very tiny hole – much, much wider than it, and he was leaning against her. Ela's face was scrunched up now, and she was shaking her head slightly against the sheets. “I can't,” she said.

Christian was watching his cock with all the arrogance of a man who simply did things like this: told women he was going to fuck them in the ass, and then did it.

He pushed against her and she howled.

But I could see that she was moving her hips backward, bumping up against his cock. She was submitting to him, she was going to let him push

inside her, even if it tore her apart.

When he pushed forward and finally stretched open the first part of her, an agonized sound came from the pile of sodden sheets that Ela had buried her head in. She roared and clawed at the bedsheets.

“Noooooooooooo,” she wailed. “No I can't.”

“Stay right there.” Christian commanded, but it was more like he was telling her what she had already done, than telling her what to do, since he said it with such confidence.

His cock disappeared inch by inch into her ass, and though Ela said *no* hundreds of times, she remained where she was, her voice getting weaker and weaker, her resistance getting weaker and weaker. And then her eyes opened, and she stared vacantly ahead of her.

I had a great view of Christian's big cock, deep in her ass, moving in and out, stretching her tight little hole open. It disappeared into her unyielding skin as she screamed about how big it was and how much it hurt.

He moved relentlessly inside of her, until she finally ended all struggle.

“That's it,” he said, in triumph. “Just take it now.”

And she did. She lay there as he pounded her ass for several more minutes. She moaned a little, and drooled from her mouth, closing her eyes at one point as he slammed into her hard.

Then he slowed, and he panted above her.

“Not yet, darling girl,” he said.

He leaned over her, and pulled her up so that she was pressed against his chest. Her hair was wet and clung to his skin in thick, sweaty ropes. She gasped as his cock shifted inside of her, pressing against all new places inside of her. Her eyes went wide with shock. He held her close to him, moving her easily with one muscled arm, and their sweat mingled as their skin mashed against each other's flesh.

He used his free hand to slide down between Ela's legs. I could not see his fingers as he slid them along her pussy, but I saw Ela's mouth open and her eyes roll back in her head as she sank into the pleasure he was giving her. Her chest heaved more and more quickly as he brought her to a climax that made her stiffen and open her mouth in a silent scream.

I knew, though I had no personal basis for it, only conjecture, that her ass was clenching tightly around his cock and spasming around his member as her orgasm twisted through her.

She let out one sharp yelp, and then she pushed her forward, letting her pant on the bed as he slid his cock in and out of her. It was stickier and more wet now, from all the juices that had dribbled down onto her stretched ass.

I stroked myself furiously now, believing this was near the end and wanting only to be relieved of the ache in my cock.

But Christian had more in store for Ela. He slid from her ass and pulled her by the ankles to the edge of the bed. I had time, as he shifted himself around, near the headboard and where Ela's head was, to stare at her asshole. It pulsed and quivered, dark black in the center and gaping with his abuse.

Christian knelt in front of Ela, and tapped her on the head.

His wet cock, covered in her pussy juices and the invisible filth of inside her most intimate hole, pointed at her as she lifted her head.

Ela's bad behavior was not over, though. She lifted her mouth to the height of Christian's cock.

I stared as she opened her mouth. I had a view of her dripping, abused asshole, and the back of her head only partially blocked the view of Christian's rigid cock, and her mouth, as she got ready to pleasure him.

She flicked her tongue out, without any bidding, to lick the tip of Christian's huge member. He pulled it up, flush with his stomach, so that with a little straining, she could lick the length of his shaft.

My cock was about to burst. My balls felt like someone had them in a vice.

Ela's full lips, the same ones I so liked to kiss, closed around the tip of Christian's filthy cock, and she sucked him into her mouth. Her cheeks hollowed out with the effort.

He let her lick and suck away for several minutes.

"That's it," he said.

He worked his fingers into her hair, and pulled it hard. As though she were a blow-up doll, she opened her mouth, with no command at all, and let him slide her face all the way down his shaft. I watched as she took the whole thing in her mouth. Down her throat, all the way in.

Christian tightened his grip on her hair and held her still. From deep in her throat came a gurgle.

Then he held her face in place while he began to move his hips. Fucking her mouth and watching his cock slamming into her face, until his

stomach muscles tightened, and I knew he was going to come.

As he came, his white cum splashed into her throat, and she gagged. Splatters of his cum sprayed out of her mouth as he continued to pummel her, and his cum seemed to fill her by the gallons.

“Swallow,” he said, and he used one hand to grind her face against his pelvis, and the other to close her nostrils shut. I saw Ela's throat, finally, swallowing.

I had to grasp a jacket, and stuff it into my mouth as my own orgasm rocked through me. Without thinking, my hands found something – I will never know what it was – and I tried to wipe myself off with it. I continued to stare as long as I dared.

He released her, and she pulled away from him almost reluctantly, licking up every last dribble of his cum.

And then she looked up, and made this sound I will never forget as long as I live: a naughty, slutty little laugh.

Christian was now facing my direction, and an instinct for self-preservation kicked in. I released the curtain, and very slowly lowered myself to the floor.

I had to wait there, while they moved around, deciding on a place to eat, telling each other about their schedules. Showering. Acting like a couple.

It was true that Christian did not seem particularly bright, or funny. Ela didn't bother with her jokes, or her usual banter. Clearly, she was using him for other things.

I didn't know if it hurt more or less that what she had told me was really true. It was really just the sex, she had claimed. And from what I heard of the aftermath, it seemed true.

It was what we had agreed to.

So why was I feeling what I was feeling?

They left, and I escaped half an hour later, after walking through the apartment and delving into Ela's things. Smelling her clothes, digging through her drawers. Finding nothing of consequence.

I was grateful the door locked behind me, and the halls were empty and dark. I left through a back door, and crossed a large, browning field. I caught a cab, returned to the airport where I collected the luggage I had planted there. I stayed in the airport hotel.

The next morning, I went to her apartment and pretended to have just arrived. She threw her arms around me and kissed me passionately.

“Why?” she said, her cheeks pink with excitement and the chilled air. “Oh my gosh, I'm so excited! But why didn't you tell me you were coming?”

Another hug.

I told her I had been thinking about it, and I wanted to end our open relationship agreement.

She backed away from me, looked me in the eye, her own eyes moving back and forth, like she was reading something.

“Okay,” she said. Casually, like it was nothing.

Then:

“What do you want to eat?”

There was one more thing she said, as she was walking back toward the apartment, dragging my wheely-suitcase behind her. She waved a mittened hand in the air, and I was reeling from everything that had just happened, so I didn't catch it until later. Much later.

“Did you try one of those Danish hot dog thingies, yet? From the little *hahvnegrillen* or whatever it is?” Despite being a musician, Ela had a terrible ear for accents and her attempt at sounding Danish came out, like all of her accents, sounding cartoonishly Indian.

Ela's brown hair was silky, her slender hands waving around in mittens and her pink cheeks and smile had pulled me in again to hopeless adoration.

So it was a long time later before I wondered about it:

Why had she asked me if I had tried a hot dog *yet*? I had told her I arrived that morning and come straight there.

Like so many things, I shoved it into a junk drawer in my mind somewhere, a place for unexplained coincidences I didn't want to deal with or could not explain, incriminating evidence against people I liked, and anything that bordered on too weird to be known about.

And that was that.

When I found her shaved pussy, maybe half an hour later, it was silky and smooth in my hand and it drove me wild to feel it on my palm, the wet slit in its center gushing its hot juices onto my hand.

“Did you do that for Christian?” I asked her, and she had shrugged in a noncommittal way, smiling. Leaving the question unanswered as I pushed

my nearly-bursting cock into her. As I fucked her, her juices slid like a river down to my balls.

Or perhaps her ass was full of cum, for who knew what else she had gotten up to that night? And it was all gushing from inside of her, and coating my balls as they slammed against her perfectly smooth taint and asshole.

The thought of which sent me over the edge, immediately.

THE ENSEMBLE

These were a few of the thing that were, I suppose you could say, in the mix, as I thought about my wife and her return to school. All of it: Christian, odd remarks, the possible history of her “other TA,” her strange blowjob for imaginary grades, her short skirts and her Lolita-ish skip to the bus...all of it was combining in very bad and very delicious ways inside of me. Driving me insane. Taking up huge amounts of my time, dedicated to daydreaming filthy scenario after filthy scenario.

Ela, after all, could be a very naughty girl. She was not afraid to cross certain lines. She was not afraid to be filthy.

A month went by, and Ela came and went from home to school. She practiced. She ate a lot of Thai noodles when I came home and then returned to practice.

My obsession began to dull, just a little.
Then she joined an ensemble.

“An ensemble, huh?” I responded. “Do you think that might be a little much?” I was barely hiding my jealousy. There was the fact that a new group would mean additional practice, and less time, therefore with me. And additional people she would be spending time with. Additional excuses for staying away late at night. I felt the potency of my obsessive thoughts returning to life.

Ela slurped up her Thai noodles, which were, at this point, the only thing I think she ate all day. She seemed thinner. She waved her chopsticks at me. “You promised,” she warned.

I had. I had promised I was not going to make comments like this.

“I have to do it. It's just...something you have to do.”

“Why?”

“Win contests, look famous, take photos, announce stuff on Facebook.”

I nodded, as if I really understood. Most of what went on in the classical music business was disappointingly similar, at the end of the day,

to what went on in any other business. Schmoozing, bombast, marketing, and a lot of people with mediocre abilities pretending to be really hot shit.

And then a lot of talented people not making it anywhere because they hated all that crap.

“I have to do it,” she said dryly.

I tried not to be annoying. “Who's in your group?” I asked cheerfully.

Ela started her sentence halfway through mine. “Did you get the insurance guy's message, by the way?” She slurped up a noodle at it whacked her on the face, which made her laugh.

And in this way, she continued to avoid the question, until it was no longer a good time to ask it.

“Who's in your group?” I ventured again, and she rolled her eyes.

“Big, hot, sexy construction men.”

“Seriously,” I said.

She tossed her hair.

“Just a bunch of music people. Do you really know who they are? John O'Connor, a Korean girl, a hairy hipster, a weird cellist, some foreign guy....you know. The usual cast.”

I thought I saw a tiny shadow of deception darken her face.

“Oh!” she yelled, before I could say anything else. “This is the best part. We'll be going to London if everything works out! You should come with us. We can see your folks.”

I suddenly felt foolish, and I wasn't even sure what train of thought I had been riding before she announced the trip. A dark one, one in which she was deceiving me and unwilling to tell me who was in her ensemble because she liked one of them...but no. Her cheery invite cast a sudden, glaring light on everything.

God Peter. Get a hold on yourself.

Ela was blinking at me. “Brilliant,” I said, treating her to my long-dissolved accent.

I was just a man, with a nice wife, who was acting like a crazy paranoid person for no good reason.

Brilliant.

ODD THINGS

But the ensemble began to eat away at our time together, as I had predicted.

This did nothing for the strange cloud of paranoia that was brewing inside of me.

There was this: Ela seemed distant when she was with me, and was always tired.

There was also: We started having sex only once a week or so. Ela would stay at school until the afternoon, and then come home and lock herself in her practice room for hours of practice. I couldn't wait her out. I fell asleep, over and over again, to the sounds of her repeated phrases, her whispered *dammits*, whole concertos.

Then she began to come home late.

She called me the first night, when I arrived home to a dark house even though it was eight o'clock. There was no sign that Ela had been home all day.

Something turned in my stomach.

As if on cue, my phone buzzed in my pocket.

"Hi, sweetie." I said.

"Hey."

An unusual choice for Ela. Or was it? Why not, *hey sweetie*? Or *honey*?

My skin prickled with an animal-like alertness. I listened to the air behind her voice, for the sounds of where she was, what was happening around her. Another man's voice.

Nothing.

"Listen," she began, and I already knew what was coming. "I have to stay here late with the group. Things are..." her voice drifted off, and then she laughed. It took me a second to realize she wasn't paying attention anymore to what she was saying to me.

What *was* she laughing at?

Was her lover, the one that was asking her to lie for him, doing impressions of me? Making faces of cluelessness to mock me?

“Sorry,” she hissed. “I...sorry.” Another laugh. “Ian's just standing on...” Another laugh. “Anyway. I have to stay late, things are a mess.”

She sounded suddenly impatient.

“Any idea what time you'll be home?”

“Oh *god*,” she said, and her voice was dripping with annoyance. Though who it was directed at was unclear. “No...no, like I said really a mess. Listen everyone's leaving for dinner now so I have to go. See you soon.”

She kissed the phone.

Was that really what she was looking at? Ian (who the hell was this Ian?), standing on something funnily, beckoning her to an opened door so they could go get something to eat? And if so, wasn't she on a bloody mobile phone? Couldn't she just *go*, without having to hang up? Like everyone else on earth?

Or had she been looking at something else? Had she been sitting on a desk, her fingers sliding along the hem of her skirt....the line of her panties....up and down, while her lover, whoever he was, watched? Listening to her lie to her husband. Had he reached up and stroked her clit through the fabric of her panties? Was that why she had laughed?

I stared at the phone.

It was *her* cell number.

In my mind, the lover slid his fingers up to the hem of her panties, right beneath her navel, and ripped them down. At times in my fantasies this was a member of her ensemble, young and muscular, strangely athletic; other times, some other, older man, a prof.

Maybe she didn't even have an ensemble, maybe this was all just an elaborate lie.

I continued the fantasy. The panties tore, and he pulled her with a jerk toward him. My wife's sweet, tangy scent flooded his nostrils with the puff of air that came with his tug, and then he hooked his arms beneath her legs. Immobilizing her, while she held the phone limply in one hand, not caring if it was really off or not, and his thumbs pried apart the lips of her cunt. So that his mouth, moving ever closer, could have easy access to all of her pink flesh, the hard, pulsing knob in the center of her.

I closed my eyes.

I was coming apart like a five-dollar watch.

I waited for Ela to come home, and I was sitting in the kitchen a little bit like a madman, or a father waiting for a teenage daughter. I had a whiskey in my hand and I clanked the ice and made her jump.

She held her hand to her heart. "Jesus!" she spat. Then she ran her eyes over the scene, calmer now that she recognized me. "Well, look who's Mr. Spooky today."

I didn't say anything, in part to make her frustrated. To make her ask me what I was doing, even though I had no answer myself.

She sighed. Crossed the room and opened the fridge. "So? What *are* you doing, being spooky down here?" She surveyed the contents of the refrigerator and sighed at her choice: a tuna salad. "Aren't you usually in bed by now?"

She didn't even look at me.

"I thought you ate," I said.

Ela shrugged. "I practiced some more and now I'm hungry." Her eyes lifted to look at me. "What is your *deal*?"

My deal. My mind was wandering, in part, to a fantasy in which I yanked her by the knee close to me, and she straddled me reluctantly as I pushed her shoulder down, and then I felt the warm, wet stain of her cum-filled pussy leaking on my thigh.

"Who else stayed with you?"

She tipped her head and a faint smile quivered on her lips. She dug into her salad and held up a piece of tuna for inspection. She squinted at it. Now she was feigning disinterest, I could see that.

"Oh...you know.....*maestro*....David....a coupla guys from the varsity rugby team..."

She couldn't even keep it together and laughed a little at the end of her sentence.

"We just had a big..." she was cracking up, "gangbang. With violins."

She was still holding her tuna up, but she was looking past it at me. Her eyes were smiling.

I was being a dumbass dick, she was saying, in her most polite way. She popped the tuna into her mouth.

"No one," she said, after chewing a bit. "Just me, in the end. Those guys are super flaky. They ate a burrito and they were outta there."

Disappointment clanged around in my chest. I was as annoyed that she had stayed alone as I was that she had stayed at all, with potential

lovers.

“Is that a good idea? Staying by yourself?”

In my mind, of course, I imagined that she had not done that at all. That she had gone home with Ian, the funny-man standing on whatever-it-was.

Or maybe she had never been there at all, at the conservatory. Maybe she had just pretended to be there, while she was in fact lounging on the filthy couch of some hipster boyfriend, who had been sliding his hands up and down the column of her thigh the whole time she spoke to me on the phone.

In my mind I went briefly to a fantasy where I would go down to the conservatory myself, the next time she claimed to be staying late, and -

And what, Peter?

She was leaning across the counter. She blinked at me.

“I mean, the janitor had his way with me,” she said, and I had to do a lot of backpedaling to remember what she was even talking about.

She snorted again.

I was mostly on my way to thinking I was being a stupid and complete idiot, when she jerked her head in the direction of the stairs.

“Come on, cowboy,” she said.

It had been a long time since Ela had just invited me to sex – the only thing she ever called me “cowboy” for.

She turned to face me and pressed her small body up against mine at the top of the stairs. I felt her mouth smiling under my lips as she felt my already-hard cock against her.

I started in immediately on her jeans, popping the button and getting my hand quickly into her pants. An unusually bold move for me, but there was something driving it, and Ela didn't seem to mind or even notice.

I slid my fingers into her panties, and when I touched her bush I almost recoiled.

“What's this?” I said, standing back from her.

She had shaved.

Almost, though not entirely. A small, feathery landing strip was all that I encountered, and then my fingers had brushed against all of the ultra-smooth skin surrounding her gash. My fingertips, too, were wet with her excitement.

Like a giant wave, all of my suspicions towered over me again.

And tantalized me with their possibilities.

Not to mention, the smooth silk of her pussy sent me over the edge with desire. My hand almost pulsed from the feel of it.

My heart was racing.

“You like it?” Ela said, and her reaction was one of coy flirting, nothing more. I searched her face for a glimmer of guilt, of having been found out or caught. But there was nothing. Nothing on Ela's face to indicate that she was worried at all about how I would take her new shave-job.

“I did it on lunch break like a day ago. Kim Lee had a coupon.”

I scrutinized her face.

Was she offering too much information? Would she have told me all of this if her trim was just, in fact, a trim she had gotten with Kim Lee, the token Korean violinist from every ensemble?

“Kim Lee gets waxed?” I said, my mouth way ahead of my mind.

Ela smiled. She put her hand up as though shielding her secret from an audience. “She's a really dirty little slut,” she whispered. “I know,” she said, putting her arms over my shoulders. “It's shocking. I always thought Kim Lee was such a nice girl...the real question,” she said, changing her voice to sultry and with it the subject, “is: do-you-like-it?”

The feel of her soft skin was still radiating on my fingers like erotic stardust. Yes, yes I fucking liked it.

But I almost liked it better thinking it had not been with Kim Lee at all. I liked the idea of it being for someone else.

I slid her jeans from her small frame and pushed her panties down to her knees. I rubbed my fingers over her mound and savored the softness I encountered. Her hair was soft, but now there was only skin, Skin and the soaked gash between her folds.

I slid a finger into the hot flesh between her lips, and encountered a flood of hot juices.

I opened my mouth, maybe to say something, maybe not. Ela found my lips with her tongue and traced her red, wet, candy-tasting tongue over them. It was not something she had ever done before, and it was exhilarating. I made a move for her mouth, but she pulled away, smiling. Teasing. She bit at my lip, snapping at it a little, and then pulling her hot little mouth away before I could have her.

Ela's panties and jeans were still around her knees, and we were precariously close to the top of the stairs. I tried to maneuver her into a room, but she turned herself and hung her body over the banisters, nearly folding in half. Her ass was turned upward and spread open slightly by this action, and then I watched, my cock pulsing with excitement but my body paralyzed by Ela's movements, as she wound her hands through the rails and ran her fingers along the inside of her thigh – up, up, to her spread gash. She slid her forefinger along the engorged flesh, and then began to stroke her clit.

It was all a display for me, and I watched it, mesmerized. Her fingers went up, and she trailed her juices over her taint and up more, to where she made a small little circle around her asshole.

The scene was lewd as hell, and I would call it to mind over and over again nearly every five minutes for weeks to come. She was so bent over, and her fingers were doing such naughty things. She made several slow, lazy circles around her ass, and then I watched like a zombie as her finger slid inside of her own asshole.

I moved toward her, and she removed her finger. It slid from her easily, and with her slippery fingers she guided my hand to her asshole. The message was clear – I began to rub her small eyelet with my thumb. I was rewarded with a gasp. I pressed inward, and her tight flesh pulsed around me, but my thumb slid in easily. I went until I was buried up the knuckle, and I felt Ela squeeze around me in slight pain.

“Now fuck me,” she breathed, and she lifted herself up with the strength of her abs to say this.

I grasped the banister and gave it a good shake. It was an old house, the railing was secure...but still...

Ela looked over her shoulder and smiled. My thumb was still in her ass and my cock was pulsing against her thigh, her juices dripping onto it. “You'll have to fuck me nice and slow,” she said, in reference to our precarious location.

And so I slid inside of her, and began to move carefully, slowly, inside of her flesh. She was so wet there was almost no friction, just heat, and I was nearly bursting but it was clear I would be there a long time, fucking her slowly so we didn't go crashing through the railing, being tortured by the feeling of my thumb in her ass and her too-wet pussy on my cock.

But Ela's pussy was quivering around me, and I felt her muscles tense. She was going to come. Her ass squeezed around my thumb and her cunt burst around me.

Her hands made their way back through the railing, and she clamped down on my balls. She kneaded them in her hand and pulled me deep inside of her, as her cunt rippled through the last waves of her orgasm.

She squeezed me with her pussy, and kneaded my balls. And like that – balls-deep in her soaked cunt and without moving an inch to actually fuck her - my cum knifed its way out me and I yelled as I filled her up.

We remained that way for a while, panting. I was dizzy from the intensity of my orgasm, and Ela was still pulsing around me, hot and liquid.

“What was *that*?” I said, finally.

Don't get me wrong, it was great. I just...couldn't believe that after all these years, out of nowhere, Ela wanted to try something like that.

She stood up. I slid from her, and she shrugged. “I learned it at school,” she quipped.

I said nothing. I wasn't sure what Ela was going for with that comment, but the effect was to make my cock, which had that dizzying, fucked-out feeling pulsing through it, twitch a little back to life.

An image of Ela bent over that way for some instructor flitted through my mind.

Meanwhile, I said nothing.

“I just wanted to try something different. Most men would *not* be complaining.”

I turned her around. She was right about that. I stroked her arm and gave her an affectionate kiss. “I'm just being...” I said. I really had no idea what I was being.

“I have to take a shower,” Ela said.

I lay awake, though, all night. The paranoia was creeping back inside of me, eating me alive.

First, the shaved pussy. Why? Sure, she could just claim it was a coincidence. But the only other time Ela had shaved so completely was for Christian. For the one time in our long relationship she had strayed.

That you know about, Peter.

I shuddered.

And then there was how wet she was. Why would she be so wet, so turned on, after staying alone and practicing and then riding home on the subway, one of the least sexy places on earth, with its filthy red-carpeted seats and advertisements for STD testing?

The feel of her soaked cunt dripping into my hand fluttered back through my mind.

And then the bending over. The contortionist act.

The fingers in her ass.

It was all too suspicious to be ignored.

Something had to be going on.

And so I lay awake nearly all night, my head awash in image after image of my wife being defiled by all or none of her ensemble members, including the slutty Kim Lee.

And just like that, the obsession flared again. To a full-fledged case of pure addiction.

LONDON

Ela was wrapped in a towel, smelling like strawberries. She had left her packing to the last minute, as usual, and was now moving in a disjointed and disorganized frenzy. Her hair was wet and clung to her skin. I watched her with fascination as she jabbered excitedly and moved from one suitcase to the next, taking things out and putting things back in.

She set two dresses down on the bed and smoothed the material of each, what little of it there was. Both were new, and without seeing them on her, I could see they were far more risque than her usual choices. She appraised the dresses.

She sighed. "I hate wearing black all the time."

Something bit me. I mean, something had been biting me for a long time now, but just then I couldn't contain myself anymore. "Does someone else want to see you in another color?"

I meant for my voice to sound lighthearted, to be able to claim that I had just made a joke. But I sounded, instead, like a psycho.

Ela's eyes fluttered with an eyeroll that I couldn't see, and she sighed again. She turned around to face me and said, in a very peculiar voice:

"Oh yes. My big, strong lover says he wants me to wear more red."

She turned back to her dresses.

I wondered if Ela knew, just a little bit, what was in my mind. Surely she had to. Surely she knew how she was teasing me.

Or maybe she wasn't teasing. Maybe she was utterly serious.

I felt my cock twitch.

I moved closer to her. "Oh yeah? And who is this guy?"

She shrugged, and I could see the ripple of her smile in her cheeks. "Just some guy. I met him at school. He's on the football team." She was being silly now, but I was serious. I moved my hand along her arm and up to her neck. I pushed her head forward a little so I could pepper her neck with kisses.

I had two choices. Go with the sure thing, the fantasy she seemed willing to talk about. Or go for broke, and try to reel it back in the direction I wanted it to go: to a real lover, a realistic one at least.

“Not your professor?” my mouth said, without giving me the chance to think things over. I moved my hand down to her breast, and gave her a quick squeeze on the nipple through the fabric of the towel. Just in case she was about to get mad and push me away.

She surprised me by smiling more.

She gave a low, rumbling laugh. Almost like a moan. “No. No, *he* wants me to wear black. Of course.”

I knew she must have been able to feel my cock getting hard close to the small of her back. Surely she could feel it. She must have known that she was turning me on.

“Tell me more,” I said.

She giggled. “Peter!” she exclaimed. “What is *with you?*”

I hesitated. Should I tell her what was with me? Did I know what was “with me?”

How does a man tell his wife the strange, crazy ideas that are in his head, and circulating around in his cock, getting weirder and weirder there? The idea that I wanted other men to touch her, other men to make her scream, other men to *have* her – and yet that he didn't want that at all?

There were darker thoughts than just that. Thoughts about wanting to actually see her getting defiled by another man, thoughts about wanting to see what the aftermath was like, physically, on her body. To feel the dried cum of another man on her skin when I touched her, to put my fingers into her cunt and feel it loose and wet around my fingertips, gushing with another man's seed...

“Peter? Seriously. Which one should I wear?”

I pointed at the one on the right.

I trailed my fingertips down her neck, and I was pleased when her skin turned to hard bumps and raised, fine hairs.

“No,” she said, sexily. “Andre won't like that one.”

I shivered again.

“Andre, huh?”

“The football player.”

A pang of hot, painful lust clanged through me, even though this was a silly game. She used this sometimes, a made-up person, a made-up lover, just to tease me.

Don't say it.

“Does 'Andre' have a big cock?”

I closed my eyes. I was going to get hit in the face.

“Very big. Not as big as *maestro's*, which is surprising. But big.”

Bigger than yours, I begged mentally for her to say.

But even without that, even without her saying that, I felt like I had entered some secret passageway. I was holding a delicate thing in my hands, hot as hell, and I didn't want to break it.

Ela, as always, had it under control. She pressed her ass against my groin, tilting herself upward to do it. She turned and exposed her neck to my mouth. She held my fingers up to her lips. “Do you want to hear what we do together?”

I murmured my assent.

“You like that?”

I just let a puff of air come out of my mouth. I was too stunned by her willingness to play along with the game to say anything that might break it.

Her hand made its way down to my groin, over my trousers, and squeezed.

Her mouth twisted in a pleased little grin. “Hmmm,” she said. “I think you *do* like it.”

A wash of memories and desires flooded my mind: Christian with his cock in her ass, the smell of her close enough for me to get a whiff of it. My fantasies about seeing her misbehave again, seeing her do some very naughty thing that I simply didn't have the...desire to do to her myself...with some other man.

“Tell me what you do with Andre,” I said.

And I knew, or at least I hoped (or did I?) that it was all a game, but nothing gave me more pleasure at that moment than the wicked little smile that turned up the corner of Ela's mouth.

“I let Andre do all kinds of naughty things with me, sweetheart. Are you sure you want to hear about them all?”

My head bobbed in what I hoped she took for a nod.

She put her arms over my shoulders. “It makes me soooooo horny to talk about it,” she complained. “I might need you to help me out,”

She was playful, and for her this was very much a game. But she was hitting all the right notes, all the right places where the pain and the pleasure were deepest for me. I didn't want her to stop.

“Tell me what you do for him,” I said.

She smiled. “Anything he wants.”

I slid my hand down her back, to her small ass, and I tapped it lightly.
“Anything he wants?”

She nodded, biting her lip. She was smiling with amusement.

I tapped her again. “Even here?”

“That's what I like best. Taking it there for him.”

My breath stopped in my mouth. After her banister-and-ass evening, I had been imagining this very thing, every night she came home late.

She had, after all, gone there with Christian. Never with me, and she didn't know what I knew. But she *had* done it. Was she doing it now, late at night, with some other man?

But “Andre” was a joke, I reminded myself.

“And what about your *maestro*? What's left for him?”

She grinned wickedly, I could see her reflection in the mirror. Her eyes were back on the dresses. “Too private.”

Something clawed inside my chest. Was she playing a game now, and if she was, how did she know that this would burn through me the most? The not knowing? The hint that she was perhaps telling the truth, that perhaps she had some private affair, but really, and she couldn't tell me about it because it was...real?

All mixed in with her game, her “Andre the football player,” who was a fiction she had invented time and time again. “Andre the delivery guy;” “Andre the garbage man;” “Andre the pilot.”

“I can show you,” she suggested.

She was already sliding down my torso, along my legs. Already getting down on her knees, her fingers tugging on my zipper.

As she pulled my already-stiff cock from my underwear, I gave myself in to the fantasy that might be real: this was how she sucked her professor's cock. *She placed her hand on it, and wrapped her fingers around the girth of it. She brought it to her lips, and rubbed the tip of it over her pretty mouth, letting his precum smear across her lower lip. She pressed her lips together, like she was applying lip balm, and tasted his cum, before opening her mouth and taking his cock inside of her.*

She looked up at him while she did this, like she was looking up at me now.

I imagined my wife on her knees, slurping away on her professor's cock, her cheeks hallowed out with the exertion, sucking his cum right out of his testicles and into her mouth. I imagined him grasping the back of her

head and pushing her face into him, until her lips grazed his balls and his pubic hair, and he could feel her throat twisting with a gag. And then he would pull and push on her strawberry-scented hair, up and down on his shaft, until he shot his full, bitter load of cum into her throat.

And just like she was now, with watering eyes, Ela would swallow it all.

The flight was crowded and full of screaming children. None of the other ensemble members were on our flight: we had booked using my air miles. Ela slammed several glasses of wine and fell asleep. She was tired after a fiery debate about her instrument, which the crew had wanted to stash in the luggage. I had stepped in, after watching her boil over, with a quote of airline policy delivered in my most lawyerly voice. Just in time, because Ela might have gotten us kicked off the plane and sent to Guantanamo if she had kept going.

I had been secretly hoping she would be as frisky on the plane as she had been at home. That her new, naughtier self would want to sneak away to the lavatory and show me again what she did for “Andre the football player,” or “*maestro*” the professor.

I inserted earplugs, which only minimally canceled out the coughing and crying around me. I looked at Ela. Her face was calm, undisturbed by guilt or worry.

I closed my eyes.

Surely, this was all just a game. And that's what I wanted it to be, right? A game?

I went through the evidence, over and over again, like a criminal lawyer for a trial. The nights she had come home late. All of them under the guise of practicing.

Could be true.

Her naughtiness with Christian, her shaved pussy.

Circumstantial.

Her new tricks, her finger in her ass...

I groaned inwardly, as the image of my wife filled my head and my cock. I tried to push the idea out of my mind, but it kept coming back. First the real Ela, bent over the banister. Then the fantasy Ela, bent over the black chairs at the music school, lying on a piano, her fingers spreading her ass

wider and wider so that her professor could watch his cum dribble from her filled, little hole...

It was a long flight.

We had a day before the concert, but Ela dedicated nearly all of it to practicing with her group. A jetlag expert by now, I rose at seven with her, and then walked aimlessly around the city, noting how it had changed dramatically from when I was last there.

My parents were in Greece, enjoying their relative wealth there and the fun of being recently retired.

I met Ela at four, for early dinner as we had planned. It was a dark, wet, wintery London night, and I shivered for almost an hour waiting for her.

She skipped down the steps and her face changed from elation to something more like disappointment as she saw me. "Peter," she said. "Why didn't you go inside? We ran way over. I only have time for a quick tea. Then I have to get back."

We ate fish and chips instead, outside at a truck, with Ela watching the city in fascination. "It's so dark," was about the only thing she said.

And then she went back to practicing, came home at ten, exhausted, and fell asleep.

"My god, this jetlag is awful."

She delivered the news the next morning from the shower.

"Peter, I have some bad news about tonight's concert," she said.

I was murderously horny by now, and I looked at myself in the mirror. My hair was too long, and it gave me a half-crazed appearance to go along with my half-crazed mind.

A cool feeling sank through me, from my chest to my toes.

"What's that," I said dryly.

She pulled a grimy curtain open. This hotel was expensive as fuck, because it was in Belgravia, but it was a shithole. "There was a big cock-up." Ela was full-on speaking with a cockney accent by the end of every sentence now.

"What's that," I repeated.

"The comps are only good for tomorrow. Apparently."

I started to open my mouth, to say I would buy a ticket.

She cut me short. "And the tickets are all sold out. So you'll just have to come tomorrow. Sorry."

She didn't sound sorry at all, my reptilian brain told me.

I groaned. I was bored, here in London, with no one to meet and nothing to do. I was hemorrhaging money and drinking too much in the hotel room, thinking about Ela.

Ela's unproven unfaithfulness. Turning it over and over in my mind.

"But then you have some kind of outing planned, yes?" I said.

"Well..." she said, and I heard her turn to be under the water. I pulled the curtain aside to peek in and watch the soap and water sliding over her lithe body. White soap was caught in the tiny patch of hair above her still-bare pussy, looking like streaks of cum.

She opened her eyes and cast me a disapproving look before turning again.

I looked at her ass.

"We probably won't," she said. "We have that concert tomorrow too."

I reached out and slid my finger from the small of her back to her ass crack.

She slapped me away. "Stop," she said.

She was impatient. She turned back to me. "I have to get going."

I withdrew to the room, and sat on the edge of the bed, watching her as she dressed. She pulled thigh-high stockings, knit, childish ones, along her long legs. Then she put on her same woolen skirt from the first day of school.

She caught me looking. "Have to be fashionable," she said. "Oh! I almost forgot, if you want, you can watch the concert online." She hurried to the small, chipped desk where my computer was open. She wrote something on a paper. As she did, she bent over, and her skirt crawled up, up, up, until just a tiny sliver of her pale flesh, just above the end of the stocking, peeked out at me. Just a little further, and there would be her panties...

She stood up. "There it is," she said. She came over to me and kissed me on the forehead.

I reached out for her leg and she let me get very close, traveling up the outside of her thigh, to the strip of flesh between the stockings and her underwear -

"Gotta go," she said. Another dismissive kiss.

“But...you're coming back here, right? To...for dinner?”

She slung her violin over her shoulder and picked up a garment bag.

“Nope,” she said. “Not enough time. Oh.” she said, reading what must have looked like disappointment on my face. “I'm sorry. We'll have fun tomorrow, I promise.”

And she skittered out the door.

THE CONCERT

A strange thing happened as I watched the concert. Almost as if my stomach was the first to see what I saw. It went cold, and the cold spread out through my gut and into my limbs as ice. But when the cold reached my groin it turned hot, and stabbed at me like a poker.

And all the while my mind went slowly through my memory, like everything in my mind had been placed, instantaneously, into a Rolodex. As if I could flip through it, finding exactly what I needed. Exactly what I needed to build my case.

When I build a case, I make note cards in my mind. I lay them out, as though on a bed. One color for each piece of damning evidence. One color for each counter-argument.

I did this now, as I watched the feed for the concert on the music conservatory's website. As another ensemble played, I stared at the screen and built my case against Ela, piece by piece.

And then, when her ensemble came on stage, I saw it all. I made a mental "card," and then another, as I watched everything unfold before me. I squinted.

How did it all connect?

As the group filed on stage, my eyes brushed away everything else on the stage. The wild, curly hair of the conductor, a true shit I had met several times. The stands, the fat cellist. The loserly viola player, the empty chairs, all of it. Until there was only Ela, snaking across the stage, her violin in hand.

And *him*.

Now he appeared to be alone on the stage with Ela, because I had mentally brushed away everything else but the two of them. He was walking behind her. He towered over her, and his lips moved. Ela's mouth smiled. Her body turned ever-so slightly behind her, and she said something. The same infectious happiness managed to crack the man's stern face.

A man with a clean-shaven head, hiding baldness.

"...like Bruce Willis..." Ela's voice drifted up from the past.

“not only was he a prof, he was a big, manly man...”

“In fact, he was once in the Mossad.”

My fingers were sweeping over my phone, with no guidance, to the web page with the program for the concert.

My eyes were on the screen, though. I followed the two of them, the way they were talking quietly, but clearly, to each other.

I dropped my eyes to scan the names, my eyes bouncing around, out of order, seeking first what I expected and then what I did not.

John O'Connor. John.

Graciela Pineiro-White. Ela.

Kim Lee. Real. Go figure.

Ian Villanova. Weird cellist. Fat.

Then my eyes came to rest on a name.

Weird foreign guy.

The usual crowd.

Ari Zurer.

Everything, suddenly, came together for me with a vacuum-like sensation filling my head.

The pain that fluttered in my chest was sweet and debilitating. I held my hand to my chest, hoping to feel that my heart was still beating, because it felt like my heart had stopped.

A big man, like Bruce Willis. And I was his muse.

The idea that this man, this invention of *mine*, this fantasy-man I had created to fantasize about in the past, for my own perverse, pleasurable jealousy – the idea that he was *real*, pressed on my temples and my chest. Not only real, but here and now. It was too much to imagine; it changed everything, forward and backward in time. It made things that Ela had said to me completely different: some things lies, some things half-truths.

And now, it made her more...what? Vulnerable? Likely to actually be cheating?

Everything I had been imagining had been kept bubbling on a back burner in my mind, a place where I knew it wasn't really all that real. And now it was boiling over, gushing on top the stove, burning through the floor and splattering all over me: there really was a big man, a man like Bruce Willis, and she spent nearly all of her time with him now.

All along, it had been none of these others. Not Ian, not John, not her fucking professor.

Was this him? The man from her past? The not-TA or the other TA?
And then, settling over me like snow, the worse question:
If it was – and oh, how it seemed to be – then why hadn't Ela said anything about him?

Why hadn't she said: *Oh remember the Bruce Willis guy from my past, the guy I fucked, the one you always joke about? He's in my ensemble. He'll be in London.*

I began to slide on the polyester bedspread, and I remember thinking I should stop myself. But I just slid and slid, until I fell onto the floor. The screen went blank with the power saver just as the quartet lifted their bows and they hovered above the strings.

Ela with her eyes forward, but her body and her heart attuned to the small movement from Ari fucking Zurer, that would tell her to begin.

The concert ended at 10:00pm.

The hour turned from ten to eleven, to twelve, to well past when the pubs would be open and only clubs remained.

I made myself a drink, and then another, watching the street and thinking about where she was right now. What she was doing.

Who she was doing.

I knew it was futile, but I texted her. We had agreed not to use our phones here, to avoid excessive charges. She had turned it off and popped it into her suitcase. I knew it was still there, not even displaying my messages. Messages she would get later, and laugh off.

The ensemble had left, and only she and Ari remained. Packing things up, deliberately slow, backstage. Until they were left alone on the scarred black floor, the curtains swaying lightly with the departure of the last person.

"I have to get back," Ela would say.

The big, Israeli-Mossad man who looked like Bruce Willis moved closer to her, sucking her in with his dominating eyes. She would feel her bare cunt, the one she had shaved for him, well up with desire.

"Okay," she would say, her eyes darting around. "But let's make it quick."

But Ari Zurer would not be quick. He would push Ela to her knees and let her taste him first, and then he would push her up against a wall,

holding her with his enormous arms. Her feet would flap uselessly in the air as he pounded her senseless with his big, thick cock...

The door clicked.

“Oh,” Ela said, and she seemed surprised and disappointed. “You’re up.”

“You’re late.”

I watched her carefully now. I watched her features, frame-by-frame, for traces of guilt or for hesitation.

“Sorry,” she said. “We-”

“You said you weren’t going out.”

She sighed.

She did not finish her sentence. She did not respond to me. She sat down on the bed and began to remove her strappy shoes.

I waited. *What the hell?*

“Did you watch the concert?” she said.

She turned to me. Her face was flushed, her cheeks lit up by an inner glow.

Her eyes were glassy.

“Are you drunk?”

She giggled. “A little.”

Rage began to boil inside of me. I pressed my lips together.

Ela’s face changed. She rolled her eyes. “I’m sorry. Just...everyone decided to go out for a drink because Martin Czechok was there,” she said. As if I knew who Martin Czechok was. One more lover, probably.

“You could have called,” I said icily, only realizing as I said it, that it was true. She had my number, after all.

“We turned off our phones.” Her eyes moved over my face. “Jesus, what is your *problem?*”

“I watched the concert,” I said.

She cocked her head. I had said it like an accusation, and she heard the tone in my voice. She said nothing, just blinked, waiting for whatever I was going to say next.

When I didn’t speak, she raised her eyebrows.

“And?”

“And maybe there’s some reason you came home late?”

It was unlawyerly. I didn’t know the answer to this question. Never ask if you don’t know the answer. It’s the first thing they teach you.

I watched her, and I knew my face was turning into something terrible. Like a bird of prey, ready to pounce on anything.

She harrumphed. “You know what? You are acting like a fucking crazy person. I'm sorry I went *out*. Jesus, I knew this would fucking happen. I knew you were going to get all...possessive of my time when I went back to school. Didn't I? I said that!”

The fiery, raging Ela was building up. Coming out of her. She was like the fucking Hulk.

I watched her. Was she being defensive? Or had I just pissed her off?

Then I remembered.

I had no conclusive proof, of course. I had a purely circumstantial case, the foundations of which were largely my own craziness.

Still, I went in for it.

“Ari Zurer.” I said.

Ela's face, jagged with her own self-righteousness, arched upward and somehow looking down at me all this time, appeared to fall like a souffle. Her skin went pale and she snapped her mouth shut.

I could see her amber eyes struggling to hold still, not to move with her mind, searching, searching for the right lie to tell.

I felt a wave of satisfaction. I had been right.

It was followed by a wave of cold fear, and a wave of lust.

I had been *right*.

Shit.

What did that mean?

Ela's was the face of someone who had been caught, and something about it – the guilt on her features, the desperation with which she was looking for a way out – was incredibly alluring. I drank it all in.

She found the answer, and her mouth turned up in a bitchy little smile and she folded her arms over her chest.

“What about *Ari*?” she said. Her haughtiness came back, flaring up and over her face like the light of a bonfire.

I felt unsure again. Maybe there was nothing about Ari.

I kept talking anyway. I was too invested in my paranoia to stop myself.

“He's the one, isn't he? Mr. Mossad? The instructor you never told me about?”

I watched her face carefully. It had to be carefully, because I was under the distinct impression that Ela was either not at all a liar or a very good liar, and there was virtually no way to detect if she was telling a lie or not.

Or if there was a way, no one on earth knew what it was.

Her mouth twitched. “Mr. *Mossad*?” She cocked her head. “You got all this from...what? Because he's a Jew?” She threw her hands up in the air.

But there it was. The tell. I worked an internship with the district attorney's office, back before I realized I hated the courtroom as much as I do, and so I spent a lot of time just shooting the shit with investigators. A lot of things they had said stuck out in my mind, like when you throw out a hypothesis you have like it's the real thing, and you get the person you're interviewing to tell you everything without telling you anything at all. Ela hadn't told the truth yet, she was still trying to lie: but she had revealed one very important thing to me by choosing to say “he”, and that was that Ari Zurer was indeed the topic of this conversation, for her and for me. And that my reference to the Mossad was not buried in her mind, where it should have been if Ari Zurer and Mr. Mossad had nothing to do with each other. She should have had to search a lot longer to find it.

It all spelled out that I was *on the right track*. The cold-hot sensation slithered inside of me.

“No,” I said coolly. “No, that's too exaggerated, Ela. Too racist for you. No, you've shown your hand. Now you tell me, why didn't you mention that Ari Zurer was in your ensemble? You mentioned *everyone else*.” I began to compile the evidence and build my own case as I spoke. “Everyone but Ari. And there *was* someone all along, someone else besides me, and I let it go, all the evidence of it, but I know there was someone -”

“It was a *joke*,” she said, but even by the end of her own sentence she lacked conviction. She deflated. She closed her eyes. She changed her tack, and decided to make a joke and confess, all at once. “That he was in the *Mossad*.” She threw her hands up and collapsed into the couch. “And it was never any big thing, we – you and me—only made it into something sort of...more than it was. So when he turned out to be...I just...it seemed easier than telling you about it. To just...not mention it. Because there's nothing there.”

Her eyes were still closed, which made me suspicious.

But the story made sense, actually. It had the ring of truth to it. It even hung together.

I studied my wife when she opened her eyes. She *looked* like she was telling me the truth now. But then, wouldn't Ela always look like she was telling the truth? The same way she looked sweet?

I folded my arms over my chest.

“Did you sleep with him?”

Ela's anger, always there, under the surface like gasoline, ready to blow, ignited.

“Did I sleep with him? *Now* or *then*? What's your question?”

She was almost spitting.

Sometimes, if Ela went this far into anger-mode, there was no return. I gave the room a quick sweep to make sure there was nothing she could break. She threw things if she got mad enough.

But she sucked in her breath and let it out, a sign she was reeling herself back in.

I quietly thanked the universe.

She looked down at her hands. “Look. You know I slept with him. A long time ago. Before you. You've *always* known that. It was a mistake, and it never turned into a big deal. It just became...something the two of us joked about.”

“There certainly seems to be something between you,” I said, accusingly.

Why wasn't I letting this go?

Ela narrowed her eyes, but something changed in them. The spark of anger in her seemed to flicker and die, and turn to amusement. “Does there.” It was a statement and not a question.

She lifted her hand and clasped the couch behind her, rubbing the fabric between her fingers. She slid a little on the cushions, and the slit of her dress, tantalizingly, slid up her legs as she did so, revealing nearly all of one thigh.

Feelings clashed inside of my chest: anger, pain, lust, strange desires.

“To tell you the truth, Peter, I don't think you dislike that idea so much,” she said.

The words dripped into my bloodstream like a drug. Cold like the outside air. Then snaking through me, right to my heart, where they beat

inside of my chest and radiated outward, until all of me high on their potency.

She was looking right at me.

I think I might have stopped breathing. I wasn't even sure I heard her right. Her tone was confusing: almost angry, but also teasing. Was she seducing me with that idea, or laying some kind of trap? Her face told me nothing. Her cheeks were flushed, but they became that way with any strong emotion she felt – which was essentially any emotion she felt. Her lips were neutral, her eyes, like her flushed cheeks, were on fire, but they told me nothing.

My brain was trying to race through all of the possibilities, all the things I could say and all the possible outcomes of saying them. Trying to choose the best one.

Ela's gaze drifted down, like something sinking in the water, swinging from side to side with the disturbed momentum of a fall. Down, down, from my eyes to my mouth, along my chest, and to my trousers.

Where they stayed, revealing nothing, and observed for what seemed like a full minute.

Then her eyes snapped back to mine.

I knew my cock was hard, but I didn't know if she had seen that -
surely she did, Peter, you fucking idiot

- and so I just remained, awkwardly dumb, staring at her.

Her hand folded over, and she touched her mouth. She bit her finger and smiled. "In fact," she said. "It would seem that you almost *like* that idea. That you almost *like* being jealous."

Her eyes narrowed again.

I knew from her face that she was shuffling through her memory, and then her eyes dilated as she pounced upon something in it. She bit into her finger again, and her lips closed around it, very sexually, very much the way she might suck my cock...a cock...

Then she totally surprised me:

"I saw you, you know."

My eyes were still on her fingers, touching her lips now in small, seductive strokes. My mind was producing image after image of her lips grazing my cock, or another man's. Poised in front of Ari's great massive body, her hand on his member, her lips pursed just as they were right now but right next to his dripping cock...

I saw you, you know.

What the fuck did that mean? My mind went to everything I was guilty of lately. Following her in my mind; watching her concert on the internet and thinking she was having an affair with a man because he was talking to her near her neck; imagining her fucking her professor late at night. But nothing I had done had been *visible*. It was all in my mind.

“Wha..?” I said, and I narrowed my own eyes to emphasize my confusion. I shook my head. I didn't know, I really didn't know what she was talking about.

She shifted in her seat, returning her hand to where she could rub the fabric of the sofa between her fingers again. “I *saw* you,” she repeated. Her voice was low, and a smile turned the right corner of her mouth upward. “In Copenhagen.”

I blinked, very slowly.

She bit her knuckle. “Look,” she said. “Maybe we just need to..talk about this. You have your things, I know you do, things that turn you on. And so do I. I think we need to talk about them. I *saw* you.”

My head was moving slowly now.

Copenhagen.

“Why didn't you say anything?” I finally managed to say.

She let her head tip to the side. “Why didn't *you*?”

We looked at each other for a moment before we both laughed. A small laugh, a still-uncomfortable laugh, but it lightened the mood just enough.

Just enough, to make me see that she was actually on my side about this. Whatever it was. There was something unfolding between us and we weren't at opposite ends of a table, fighting it out. Maybe we could be complicit in our desires.

But I wasn't sure what to do next. Not really. The truth was, that as I remember this, of course I know *now* what it was that I wanted. At the time, though, I wasn't as certain. I didn't know what I wanted her to do or say next.

She pulled on a strand of her hair and looked at it as she wound and unwound it from her fingers. “I liked you watching me,” she said, suddenly tender. “That's why I didn't say anything. I saw you follow me,” she said, to cut me off as I tried to ask how she had seen me. “I knew you were in my

closet. I mean, Jesus, Peter. Like I didn't know there was a man in my closet.”

I felt like all of the air in the room gave a sudden pop.

I liked you watching me. Her words ricocheted in my head.

We stared at each other.

Ela's face seemed to light up with excitement. A bad kind of excitement, like a kid about to steal something. Then, just as suddenly, the glow faded and her eyes fell. She gave a little shake of her head.

“What?” I said.

“No,” Ela sighed. “No, it would just end up getting too complicated.”

Disappointment came over me, and she must have seen it on my face.

“Don't you think?” she insisted. But now it was like when we decided to open another bottle of wine, and one of us said, “no, we should be responsible,” but didn't really mean it. Now it was clear that we both wanted to open this “bottle.”

“It didn't before,” I ventured, meaning Copenhagen.

Ela's face changed again, as she considered that truth. If anything, we had gotten even closer because of her adventure with Christian and my watching it, right? We had gotten married because of it; we had both liked it; we had both admitted it now.

But her face fell again. “The thing is...neither one of us knew the other one knew about that,” she said.

I plunged in, taking up the case like a lawyer.

“Okay...so....this would be even less likely to cause conflict.”

The excitement in my voice made her eyes snap back up to mine. She twisted some more of her hair in her fingertips.

“You really want this, don't you?” she said.

Now she had a kind of morbid curiosity lighting up her eyes. I hated this look in a lot of ways. It was the look women get when they know they have you over a barrel because of your cock. She twisted a little, amused by her powers.

Fuck it.

I suddenly realized I really *did* want this, and I was as close to the moment as I would ever get. If I didn't ask for it now, we might slip back into a cycle of games and teasing again. And even though I wasn't entirely sure of Ela's commitment to really doing it, I had to take a chance.

“Yeah,” I said, and I moved close to her, sitting on the couch next to her in a crouch. I slid my hand up her torso, and then grabbed her by the neck – not too firmly, just enough to make her face change to a startled pleasure. I rubbed my thumb over her collarbone. “I really *do* want this.”

Ela's eyes lit up with excitement. One corner of her mouth turned upward. I found where the fabric of her dress bunched up, near her hips, and pushed it roughly up to her waist. Ela turned and collapsed sideways, falling onto the small sofa so that I could lie on top of her. I undid my pants first, taking myself out before I got on top of her. I never lost eye contact with her as I did this, and she looked at me with her fiery eyes. She was reeling me in, amused, aroused.

“Tell me,” I said, and I didn't even finish the sentence. Did I mean for her to tell me about Ari, or about being with another man, or just for her to talk dirty to me? I was opening my mouth to finish my sentence, and moving my hand down to her underwear, where I could feel her moisture through her panties. I curled my fingers against her through the fabric, and she raised her body up to mine.

“Tell you how another big, hard cock feels inside of me?” she responded, with her mouth next to my ear. “Is that what you want to hear?”

She had her arm around my neck and was pulling me closer. She found my cock with her hand and squeezed it, harder than I can remember her squeezing me before. She ran the pad of her thumb over the tip of my cock, and her eyes lit up with her discovery: it was wet with precum. She brought her thumb to her mouth, and sucked on it. “Or tell you what it's like to suck another man's cock until he comes?”

I shuddered with pleasure, and pushed Ela's panties aside to get my cock inside of her. “Keep talking,” I whispered, watching her lips close around her thumb. I imagined them closing around Ari's cock, or around Christian's cock. Or really, anyone's. Any cock but mine.

Ela sucked on her finger for a moment, and I found her overflowing hole with my cock. Her panties scraped against me and I pulled at them impatiently, stretching the fabric, tearing apart of it, pushing my way into her while I watched her mouth.

She pulled me close to her as I sank into her to my balls. She whispered next to my ear. “I love being all filled up by another man,”

I groaned and began to rock gently back and forth inside of her.

“I like feeling his cock all the way inside of me. Deep inside my ass, stretching me open until I can hardly breathe.”

“More,” I said hoarsely.

“Fucking me until I scream. Hammering me with his big, fat cock, riding me like a little whore,” she whispered, and her own breath was coming in ragged gasps now. Her pussy had turned to a well of molten nectar, and she squeezed against me.

“More,” I said. I was close to coming now, and only one more syllable from Ela would push me over the edge. I knew when I came it was going to come from deep inside me. In my mind I let the images of Ela fucking Christian replay wantonly. I imagined her ass, gaping and raw, and her mouth filled up with his cock, as she whispered her final, dirty comment:

“I like to feel another man's cum filling up my hot, wet cunt.”

I yelled and arched my back as I pounded my seed into her. Her pussy pulsed around my cock and she closed her eyes, her mouth open and frozen into a wide “O” of pleasure. She bucked up against me to make herself come.

I lifted her, with myself still inside of her, and we rocked the final waves of our orgasm out with Ela sitting on my lap. Then she leaned against me, panting.

There was a silence, and then Ela giggled.

“You ruined my dress,” she whispered.

I wondered if, like so many other times, we would just circle close to this...thing I wanted, and then Ela would brush it away, turn it into a joke, and never let me bring it up again.

She surprised me by saying this next:

“Okay. Truth.” She pulled away from me to look into my eyes.

I held my breath. I had thought everything was on the table already.

“I still have an attraction to him.”

If I wasn't so spent, already, it would have filled my cock to hardness again. I felt myself twitch.

“Ari,” I said. His name sounded strange on my lips.

She nodded. She bit her lip.

“I...listen, I only play along with this because...well, you seem to get off on it. For real. But is this something we really want to do?”

“*Why* are you still attracted to him?” I said. I wanted to hear it. Now it wasn't just something dirty to say while we fucked, but a real question.

She shrugged. “He's hot. Sort of...aloof. He was....good in bed. But...” she sighed, and raised herself up so that I slipped, still semi-hard, from inside of her. She moved to the bed. “Here's the thing, Peter, and I really mean this. It's like with Christian. He's good in bed because there's nothing else, you know...mucking things up, like trying to have a real relationship or connect in some real way. He's this...I don't know...”

“Strong silent type.” I was a little out-of-it, with that fucked-out feeling tingling all over my body. Having this conversation seemed surreal.

She smiled. “Yeah...and like...scary, you know. Like he really *might* be some kind of secret agent or something.”

“Women like that,” I said.

She collapsed on the bed, pulling her feet up so that she was facing me, at the edge of the bed, on her side. Her hair was spread out behind her and she pushed a sweaty strand from her cheek. She was gorgeous, in that particular moment. “I like it like you like bimbos. You know?”

“I don't like bimbos,” I said.

She waved at the air. “You don't like bimbos for relationships, but you watch all *kinds* of bimbo porn.”

I didn't bother arguing with her, or asking why she knew that, or being pedantic about the point that the porn I watched was mostly stuff that emulated what I imagined her doing with other men.

There was a long pause. “I just...I just couldn't be so dirty with you, you know. And it's fun with a guy like Christian, or a guy like Ari, because there's nothing to deal with afterward. I don't have to put up with their shitty personality all the time.”

I was silent.

“Hey,” she said, and propped herself up on her elbow. “I'm just being honest, here. I haven't ever done anything outside of our marriage, and I'm only talking about it because you seemed into it. Now *you* tell me. What do you like about the idea?”

I closed my eyes. Wasn't this exactly what I had wanted all along, even without allowing myself to realize it? Why was I hesitating? I sat on the couch so that my back was against its back.

She lay back down. “You like how dirty it is,” she said, with a lawyer's conviction. “You like seeing me be naughty, even if you don't want

to actually...I don't know...defile me that way yourself.” Then she seemed unsure. “Is that it?”

I liked seeing her with another man.

I really liked seeing her get tossed around with a big, athletic man. I liked seeing her lips around another man's cock, and I liked the idea of her getting pumped full of another man's cum.

That was the truth.

I opened my eyes.

“Can I just say, I like it, and I like it because I like it?” I said. I was feeling exposed for some reason.

She sat up. She touched her fingers to her lips. I had no idea what the gesture meant.

But she snorted. “It's a bit cryptic. Which is not why I married you, you understand.”

She was smiling when she moved her fingers from her mouth. “Look, it's not something we have to do. Maybe...you didn't really want it to be real-”

I felt everything slipping away from me. I flailed my arms a little, reaching forward to grasp her wrists, to stop her from moving away from the place we had reached. No, there was definitely something I wanted here.

“No,” I said, firmly. “I do. I just...I have a hard time explaining why.”

“Why's that?”

I covered my own face with a pillow from the couch as I leaned back. It smelled like mildew, like most of London.

Why, indeed?

I felt Ela's hand on my chest. She had come back to the couch, to climb onto my lap. “Okay, look. Peter seriously. I'm into it. But only if you really want it.”

There was a pause, and I knew she was smiling even though I was under the pillow. “I don't have to know what it is,” she said, to my silence.

That was the first time it was clear as day to me: Ela had her own agenda. And even if I couldn't voice my own thoughts to her, or even articulate them to myself, it didn't matter.

She understood them.

She found my cock with her hand, and pulled the pillow away from my face. She seemed unsurprised to find my cock hard again, and she smiled with tenderness as she guided me inside of her for the second time.

I felt her surround me, with all of her hot, liquid flesh, and I let myself give over to the feeling. With her eyes on mine, she rode up and down on my cock. It was a quiet, long lovemaking session, with Ela on top of me the entire time. Looking at me, communicating to me the same things we had discussed, but on some other, animal level. There was no dirty talk, just her body, moving over mine. Her eyes, telling me she loved me. Her smile, telling me everything was okay.

When I came, it snuck up on me out of nowhere, and she pulled my face to her chest and stroked my hair as she ground her own body against mine to bring herself to orgasm.

And like that, our complicity was born.

THE PLAN

There were several versions of The Plan, each one hashed out over dinner. Playfully, and ending in giggling disaster. Ela suggested stuffing me into a hard, fiberglass flight case for an upright bass, which was amusing and somewhat appealing to me. It was, however, an idea we had to nix because she couldn't guarantee that she could get Ari to fuck her in the room where it was stored.

“Or,” she said, mischievously, “get you out of the case afterward.”

I was enjoying planning with Ela. It began a little awkwardly, but when we added some wine and began to relax it became fun and intensely erotic. It almost always ended in very hot sex. Most importantly, making this sordid little plan together was allowing us to talk about things we'd kept hidden from each other throughout our marriage.

“You're good at stalking,” she teased me, referencing the now-shared memory of Copenhagen. “Just stalk me.”

And then we laughed, together.

All of our plans, the serious and the silly, seemed futile if I were to try to get a good view of things.

And this was the crucial part, I realized. I wanted to *see* her.

I was enjoying, though, the slow buildup to the moment, created by our inability to make a plan that would work.

“Are you teasing him?” I asked her, stroking her hair in bed. I loved the idea of Ela slowly stringing Ari along.

“I flirt with him. I have to take it easy,” she said. She was smiling.

“What do you do?”

“Look beautiful. Bat my eyes.” She blinked.

I wanted more details, and I told her so. “Aggggh!” she said, craning me with another pillow. “See? This is why you have to see it. I can't...describe things like that without...I don't know, laughing.”

I smiled.

She put a hand on one hip, and threw her hair back, trying to recover her serious face and show me how she flirted with Ari. For a second it worked. She lowered her long eyelashes to her most doe-like setting, and fluttered them lightly. She bit on her lower lip with her slightly crooked

tooth, and smiled. She was so masterful, so perfect. “Ari,” she purred, and her voice was sexy but it was wavering. “Can I borrow your rosin? You have such...” she was stifling a laugh now, but desperately trying to keep a straight face. “Such hard, beautiful rosin, and I want to rub it all over my bow.” She was hysterical by the time she got to the end of her sentence and collapsed on my legs, covering her face and laughing.

“I hope you don't do *that*,” I said, when I recovered.

She pushed her hair off her face and blinked at me. “No. No, I'm very serious.”

And she was, suddenly.

“What if we get a hotel and I hide there ahead of time?” she said, breaking a minute-long silence abruptly, turned on her side and propping herself up to look at me.

She thought on her own suggestion, her eyes misting over as she planned the whole scenario in her mind.

“No,” she said. “No, Ari is...tricky. He'd want to think he had control over things. I think it would...take away from the moment if I already had a hotel room. He would get spooked by it.”

“Hmmm.” From what Ela told me, Ari was definitely a kind of control freak.

Ela climbed onto me, resting her chin in my stomach and blinking up at me. “I have an idea,” she said. “I know it would work. But...”

I stroked her hair. I already sort of knew what she was thinking.

“But what?”

Ela looked sideways and moved her jaw back and forth. It moved her throat over my cock, and even though we had just had sex, I was getting hard again.

“Well...we could do it here. I was thinking if I told him you were out of town, and got a ride from him or something, which he is always asking me if I want, then I could invite him in...and I would text you to let you know, you know? That way we couldn't miss.”

It was a good plan. I was silent. Not because I didn't like it, or needed to think about it, but because I was imagining hiding behind the privacy screen I was going to buy tomorrow, and listening to Ela laugh downstairs, waiting for her to pull Ari Zurer up the stairs behind her and into our bed...

“Is that too weird?” she said, mistaking my silence for insecurity.

“I was just getting lost in a fantasy,” I said.

“Mmmm.”

“So I would hide behind...something over there?”

Ela smiled, and began to move downward, trailing her chin along my hardened shaft. “Mmhmm.” She grinned.

“And then you would do what?”

Her chin had reached the end of my shaft, and my cock sprung up and pointed straight into the air. Ela moved her lips very close to my shaft, and brushed just the tiniest breath away from my cock, without touching me. Her breath grazed my skin as she said: “What do you want me to do?”

My mouth was open, and I was watching her lips, moving up and down next to my shaft, promising to press against me but never doing it. I sucked in my breath.

“Do you want me to suck his cock?” Her eyes moved away from my dick to focus on me. She smiled.

“Or just tease him?”

“Suck his cock,” I breathed.

Her lips were at the top of my cock now, where almost unbelievably, a bead of precum had pearled at the end. Her mouth was very close now, and her warm, wet breath curled the tip of me as she whispered. “Do you want me to swallow his cum? Or would you rather see him come all over my tits?”

She licked at the precum, very delicately, barely touching my cock at all.

I was so high-strung I could barely speak.

“Or maybe,” she suggested, “you want him to fill up my ass, so you can bend me over later, and pull my ass apart with your fingers, and see what he left in there?”

“Jesus,” I said. I had never even imagined that Ela could talk like this.

She giggled, which in other circumstances might have ruined the moment.

I couldn't take any more, and I reached out to grasp her head, and push her down onto my throbbing cock. The smile only left her face when her mouth was too full to have any expression at all.

She didn't have to do much, before I felt myself stiffen with the impending climax. She was down deep on me, and she grasped my cock with her hand as she slid her mouth off. She pumped my cock with my head next to her lips, and smiled because she knew I was imagining her ass full

of Ari's cum, even while my own seed exploded and streaked across her pretty face and lips in sticky, white ropes.

We had a plan.

THE WAITING GAME

Then came the waiting game.

Ela had not begun to flirt with Ari in any serious way, as she put it, until we had firmed up the plan. And then, she insisted, she needed to make it all seem natural. “Natural,” in this case, seemed to mean drawn-out.

I spent a great deal more time, in the car, or at work, thinking about Ela and what she was doing to flirt with Ari. When she arrived home, it was all I could do to ask a few unrelated questions, or make some small-talk, before I dove in to ask what I really wanted to know: what had happened that day between her and Ari?

“I don't really think guys give a shit about this stuff,” I told her, finally, referring to flirting. “If you say, 'I want to fuck you in my bed at home while Peter's out of town,' I feel like he'll come right over.”

Ela smiled. “You are all the same, it's true. But...I want him to think he's sort of seducing me, you know? Like, he's gotten me to do something really naughty. Also...I think he *was* maybe in the Mossad.” She smiled in a way that indicated this was a joke, but maybe not. “I don't feel like he'd take very well to being a...what did you call it?”

“A bull.”

Ela snickered.

She was sizing up the privacy screen I had purchased while we had this conversation. It was a (very expensive) walnut four-panel room divider, selected based entirely on the fact that it was intricately carved and therefore had numerous holes in the woodworking through which I could have a good view of the room. She hung a scarf on it. “For authenticity,” she said. She reached up and shook the screen, as though testing how sturdy it was. “Nice.” She changed the subject quickly. “Anyway. Let me do it my way.”

So we did.

She would text me by 6pm if she thought the day might be a good one. It was a little tricky, because I never knew if I could get out of the office fast enough to get home and hide before they arrived.

“If I'm not there,” I said, “I don't want you to do it.”

Ela smiled. “Of course not. Should you put some kind of sign for me? Like...I don't know, an upside-down glass on the table?”

She was really getting off on the tradecraft of this idea, this plotting and the scheming, the spy-like things we would have to do to pull off our plan.

“Great idea,” I agreed. I still almost could not believe that this was really going to happen. That Ela was going to go all the way.

“I want to warn you,” she said, with her lips close to my cock after another round of sexy, fun, scheming. “Ari and I were very...” she made a face. “Dirty. Together. Is that what you want?”

I made a sound, one I hoped she took for assent, as I pushed her head onto my cock.

I wanted it dirty, I wanted it filthy.

I wanted a performance from Ela that I wouldn't forget.

Ela called me at work on a clear-blue December day. As soon as I saw her face displayed on the screen, at 1pm, I knew this was the day.

“Listen,” she said. “I think I have it all set up, so I just wanted to give you a heads-up that you need to be...er...home tonight by around like six, if you can.”

I was silent.

“Peter?”

“I'm here...just...excited, I guess.” I laughed a strange laugh.

“I just want to check, one more time: you're into this?”

My breath was shaky. I knew I should have had some kind of moment there, where I gave things a little more final, reflective thought. I mean, this was permanent. My wife was going to break the vows of marriage at my behest, and there was no going back from it afterward.

But just as I had when I married Ela, I didn't feel any need to reflect more than I already had. I knew this was what I wanted. All of the thinking that needed to be done had been done, while we planned this together.

"I'm into this." My shaky breath did not translate into a shaky voice. I sounded solid, assured. And I was.

"Tell me how you're going to do it." I said, kicking my office door closed.

"Oh, Peter, you're so funny," she said, her voice suddenly changed and lilting, as if I had really made some kind of joke. Then crisp and businesslike. "Yeah, that's fine. Just send me the new itinerary. Listen, I have to go, we're going to start up again. I just wanted to call you and tell you it's no problem."

I would never have made a very good spy, informant, or anything of the sort. "Uh..." I said, my mind still not catching up to the fact that she was putting on a show, most likely for Ari, setting up some kind of back story for his benefit.

"I love you too, sweetie. Don't forget to text me if you change your mind and want me to pick you up."

I got it, suddenly. Her secret code for, *if you change your mind and want me not to fuck Ari Zurer*.

"Uh..yeah. You, too," I said, lamely.

"God, you're so bad at this," she whispered, but her smile came through the phone. "Gotta run. Love you."

And she was gone.

Ever since we had decided to be honest with each other back in the hotel room in London, I felt like things had improved between me and Ela. It didn't mean, though, that I didn't struggle inwardly with the fact that...well, wasn't it a little bit *wrong* to want to watch your wife with another man? Wasn't it going to lead to all kinds of problems? And if it didn't, what did that say about us?

I reminded myself that this entire thing had begun, really, with my own paranoia about my wife. My own sense of insecurity, that she was too pretty, too young, and too...vibrant...to be stuck with a man like me. Her admission that she had known about me watching her with Christian, and her openness toward my fantasy, had dual and opposing effects. On the one

hand, it was exciting beyond measure. It was what I wanted. It was something I fantasized about and she was willing to make it real.

On the other hand, there was a part of me that couldn't entirely suppress my paranoia. It had felt good, for a while, to be convinced that Ela had never cheated on me, and that the only times she had strayed had been with Christian and at the beginning of our relationship, with Ari. Before anything was serious or exclusive. It felt good to speak openly about it, to have the assurances about questions I hadn't wanted to ask for fear of the answer, or because I didn't want to seem crazy.

But her willingness to do this begged another question: what if this was something she wanted to do because I was unsatisfying to her? What if she decided that Ari was who she should have chosen so long ago? Not only did they have the same interests, work the same jobs, and have so much in common, but perhaps she would remember that he was the better lover, the bigger cock, the masculine and mysterious man that I was not?

Why was it that Ela felt better about doing these filthy things with other men and not with me? She had answered the question honestly, when I had asked her about it. *Because it's not really you, Peter. It's not your thing. And it isn't really my thing, either. Not all the time.*

But what if that wasn't true? Or what if Ela only thought it was true, and then discovered it wasn't? What if she got a taste for nasty sex with other men, and lost her appetite for sex with me? Plain old Peter? What if I was putting everything on the line, here, and I would lose it all?

Ela had assured me this wasn't the case, but how can any of us know what will happen in the future?

I spun in my chair and looked out the window. Ominously, some dark clouds were gathering in the distance. Put my fingers on my eyelids and tried to will myself into a more pleasant fantasy about what was about to happen. I tried to imagine what I would get to see, and smell, and hear.

But so many things twisted inside of me, and it gave me that cool, excited ache. And ache in my chest that worked its fingers down to my groin. But I still spent most of my time thinking not so much about sex, and almost entirely about whether or not I was making a huge mistake.

Needless to say, I had an unproductive day.

I headed home at 5:30 and sat in the stillness of our house. It was dark by that time, and I didn't turn on the lights, almost wanting to shed no light on anything until I received Ela's message.

At 6:01, the words materialized on my phone. The device buzzed in my hand, where I had been holding it, my palms so sweaty it was a miracle I hadn't short-circuited it.

[Ela]: It's on. XOXO.

I blinked. I wiped my face. I was actually sweating.

Now was the time. Now was the time to call everything off, if it was going to get called off.

But I knew I didn't really want to. The thought came to me suddenly, and I turned over a water glass on the counter, displaying it prominently on the counter.

Everything I was feeling, all of the risk I was obsessing about – that was what I wanted. A strange kind of relief flooded me as I understood this. This was what it was all about, all along. Risking Ela's love, in the most intimate way, to see if all of this was really real.

The upside-down glass on the counter gave me a slight flutter in my chest. It was, after all, symbolic of the way that Ela and I shared this fantasy.

I left the lights off, and turned on only the bedroom light to get myself comfortable behind the room divider. I sat on the window-seat, and the silence absorbed me. I let out a snort, because all at once it all seemed so lurid.

Then I fumbled with my phone. There was a final detail to the plan that I did not want to screw up.

I typed my message, getting it ready, and then left it on the screen, ready to send.

And I waited.

THE PERFORMANCE

Our bedroom faced the back of the house, but through the door and the hallway I had a snippet of the front yard. After what really did seem like an eternity, headlights swung across the walls and the shadows shifted in such a way that could only be a car in our driveway. Next to mine. The back story was that I had left the car behind, and Ela was going to pick me up from the airport to save on parking. If Ari asked, which he was unlikely to do.

The door clicked open and lights made the stairwell glow as Ela turned them all on.

I heard glasses clinking.

Their voices at first were very loud, almost clear. They were talking about something to do with music – some unintelligible conversation about how Sergio was an idiot for starting an audition on an F sharp (“how could anyone be such an *idiot?*”) I rolled my eyes, though it was hypocritical. I'm sure everyone sounds like a snob about their own profession. There's just something particularly annoying about classical musicians being snobs.

It was almost amusing, being upstairs by myself, listening to Ari and Ela snob it up.

But then their voices dropped. Maybe there was a silence. They began to murmur.

I imagined the scene: *they've been flirting all day. A joke is made, and Ela laughs. Then one of those tense silences fills the air. She lowers her eyes and looks at her wine. She gives it her expert spin. Ari tells her, in a low voice, that maybe he should go home. A classic line, meant to get a woman to say, “no, don't.”*

Ela looks disappointed.

“I wish you wouldn't,” she tells him. Her voice is like the warm, velvet warble of a cat. Ari knows what she's saying, but still they have to go through this elaborate dance. Because Ela is married, Ela is mine.

She takes a sip of her wine. She can't be too eager, she has to show some resistance.

(Although maybe, my paranoid-mind offered up – maybe Ari and Ela have contrived this whole thing together, the two of them, and I am the one being taken for a ride here. Maybe this was all a way for Ela to cheat on me without any sanctions.)

No. It was too elaborate. Ela had plenty of opportunities to cheat without all of this...theater.

Their voices were low, and then they were gone. I had to actually grip the ledge of the window-seat to stop myself from trying to creep to where I could, maybe, look down and see them.

Patience, Peter. You're so close, don't ruin it now.

What was she doing now? Were they close to each other's faces, their lips only inches apart? Was it like that time with me? *I shouldn't*, Ela might be saying, and her breath slides along his lips.

There was movement all of the sudden. I heard a chair scrape carelessly on the floor. Then I heard running, and my heart began to pound faster. Had things fallen apart? My blood filled with adrenaline. Maybe Ari was some kind of rapist asshole...

But Ela's giggle preceded her lighthearted, quick footsteps up the stairs. She was laughing, “running away” from her lover. Teasing him, so that he followed her up the stairs.

Bringing him to where I was.

As we had agreed.

“I like the light on,” Ela said, as she sauntered into the room and pulled her sweater off.

Ari shrugged, moving around the bed, casting a few looks at the room itself. They had entered the room being silly and laughing, but his face took on a serious expression now. He seemed to be appraising Ela's life somewhat. How had she ended up, with this other man? I was secretly pleased that so much of what adorned the walls was tasteful and expensive. Ela's husband, it all said, had a real job and made real money. An odd, primal pride fluttered around inside my ribcage.

They were standing, now, on opposite sides of the bed. I could see past Ari to Ela, who gave me a look through the privacy screen. It burned right through me, her slight smile, her wink without winking.

She was getting ready for a performance, and she was going to do it all for me.

Everything but what I was about to see left my mind. Something in this look assured me that Ela was here not for Ari, but for me.

She slid a finger beneath the spaghetti strap of the camisole that had been beneath her sweater. She lifted the strap, running her finger along the string. When she dropped it, it slipped down, off her shoulder. While Ari watched, she slid out of her jeans, maneuvering her narrow hips out of them without unbuttoning them. She was wearing a black pair of low-cut panties, and she slid a finger briefly beneath the fabric along her hip. Her eyes moved from me to Ari, and she bit her lip. "So," she said. She put a bare knee on the edge of the bed.

"How has being married treated you, Ela? Are you still the same wild, little girl?"

Ela moved her hand from her neck, between her breasts, and down to her panties again. She slid her hand under them and ran her fingers along the hem of the fabric. I, like, Ari, supposed this was her answer. She gave a smile.

She crawled onto the bed, on all fours, and moved toward Ari.

I grimaced, because I wasn't going to have a very good view of what she was doing, if she was going to start sucking his cock now. Ari leaned his knees on the side of the bed, and made a grunting noise, as Ela unzipped his pants and took out his cock.

I strained to see a glimpse of it. I was a little disappointed in Ela for not thinking about the angle she was at.

I wanted to *see* what I could only imagine right now: her mouth was opening, and she was slowly taking his cock into her mouth. Her head began to bob, Ari began to moan, and slurping sounds reached my ears.

Damn. It.

But Ela was ready with her plan, and I shouldn't have doubted her. She only sucked for a moment when she stopped, and leaned back on her heels, stroking Ari's shaft with her hand.

She gave him a wicked little grin. "Have you ever face-fucked anyone before?"

I could tell by the slight start that Ari gave that even he was surprised. The whole scene, of course, was entirely incongruous with most people's versions of reality: Ela, sweet and pristine-looking, classically trained violinist, classy lady, married, was kneeling on her husband's bed and asking another man if he would face-fuck her.

She hadn't mentioned this particular aspect of the plan. What she would do. That she would take the lead like this. My stomach flopped.

She didn't give him much time to answer or ponder the whole thing, but instead impishly smiled and turned onto her back, sliding under him.

And that's when Ela's plan became clear: her head appeared between Ari trunk-like legs, after he slid his pants and underwear away. Her silky brown hair hung over the bed, and then her face appeared: she looked right at me and smiled.

And then Ari bent his legs a little, and used one hand to guide his erect member toward Ela's mouth.

Now that I could see it, angled down at my wife's waiting mouth, I could see that Ari's cock was extraordinarily thick, pale pink, and meat-like in a way that made it look almost overstuffed. For length, he was almost average, but this guy's cock was *thick*.

And so, when Ela opened her mouth for him, her lips were quickly spread wide, and her jaw was pried open. Her eyes began to water almost immediately, as inch after inch of Ari's cock disappeared into her widely-stretched mouth.

She left her eyes open, though, looking toward me, treating me to this one-of-a-kind pleasure of seeing a truly filthy porn performance, but with my own wife as the star. The tip of Ari's cock was pressing up against her throat now. All the way, all the way into her throat until his balls – big, dark, loose purple sacs, landed neatly on her nostrils.

Ari ground himself into her, moving his hips not back and forth, but side to side, really smashing his whole cock as deep into her face as he could. Ela blinked, and tears dripped down her forehead, but she kept her eyes open even as they reddened and welled up with tears.

He was in there for so long that I almost jumped out to stop him from choking her, but he withdrew after thirty seconds or so and Ela gasped: a wet, mucousy gasp. She struggled to get as much air in as she could before Ari went in again.

“Like that? Is that what you like?”

Ela moved her head, minutely, because it was all she could do, in assent. Her face was held almost motionless by Ari's cock, but I could see him rippling with pleasure as she made the feeble motion with her head. With a wet, sticky sound he moved back and forth inside Ela's mouth, and his fat balls slapped against her nose with the motion. She kept her eyes on

the room divider, where she knew I was watching, and even wound her hands around his legs to give me a little wave.

I was so transfixed by the sight of Ari's cock moving inside the hole of her mouth, that I didn't see for a moment that Ela had spread her legs open. She had propped them on either side of her body, knees bent. Ari's view from above would begin with her neck and the bulge of his cock roughly moving inside of it, to her tits bouncing in the camisole, to the skimpy wedge of underwear covering the place between her legs. Her open, inviting legs.

I could see from the angle of his head that he was enjoying the visual, with his neck craned to look straight down. I wondered what he savored the most. As for me, Ela's body seemed contorted, and I could look at her legs akimbo on either side of Ari's heaving ass. And her eyes beneath his ball sac, watering, red, and submitting entirely.

But submitting, as only I knew, not to Ari – but to me.

Ari gave her another deep, long thrust, and Ela blinked away the struggle as she waited for him to release her. I am sure her lungs were screaming by the time he withdrew his fat cock slowly from her mouth. Inch by inch, as Ela blinked and tried to twist her head. When he finally freed her, she gasped at the air and reached for his cock, to stop him from going in again. She scooted onto the bed so that her head was facing up at the ceiling, and guided the length of his shaft along her extended tongue. Then she used her tongue to suck his balls down into her mouth, nibbling them up until both sacs were inside. Ari was resting with both knees on the edge of the bed now, and soon my view of what Ela's mouth was doing was blocked out by his body, as he began to double over from the pleasure of having my wife take his entire sac into her mouth and swirl it around.

Because I had the option of preparing for this scene, I was in only my boxers, and my hand slid easily beneath the fabric. I clutched my cock, and it pulsed wildly in my hand, but I didn't want to stroke myself yet.

I knew Ela, and I knew she was going to give a great performance. She would not stop here. I knew she was only going to get lewder. Not because she was a particularly lewd woman – she just knew it's what I wanted to see.

I shuddered with the delightful thought that my wife wanted to give me what I wanted so much that she would debase herself in all the ways she was about to.

Ela moved, suddenly, and slid in an economical movement away from Ari and twisting around at the same time, until she was on her knees and facing him. Her face was shiny, and her mascara had smeared above her eyes, giving her a dark shadow and a slutty appearance. Her hair was wet with her own spit, and her lips seemed almost puffy from the fucking she had just taken.

She gave Ari, and therefore me, a sultry, challenging look.

“I’ve been a very bad girl,” she said.

I watched as Ari's bulk shook with a kind of chuckle, and it took me a moment to realize this was some kind of private thing between them, a game they had once played, and so it was a cue from Ela that Ari understood perfectly. He rose to his feet, and I moved to the side, to a new hole in the divider, to get a view of Ela. She watched, one finger in her mouth, as Ari raised his pants to his waist, to my confusion. He slid his belt from the loopholes and let his pants and boxers fall to the ground so he could step out of them.

He slapped the belt on the bed, and let it rest there, but the sound sent a shiver through Ela and through me. The implication was clear.

In one smooth movement he got onto the bed and reached for Ela, grabbing her by the underwear and jerking the fabric so that the panties shredded.

I widened my eyes and stared: she had shaven away even the landing strip, and was now completely bare.

Ari grunted in approval. Ela was closer to him now, and he turned her around and pressed her back against his chest for a moment. The large mirror on the other side of the room provided me with a partial view of what he was doing: his large hand ran up, under the fabric of Ela's bra, clutching her tit for a moment and then moving up to her throat. He nuzzled her neck and her ear, and whispered something to her. Instructions, perhaps. Because Ela fell forward when he withdrew his hand.

But Ela did me the favor, at least, of turning toward the head of the bed, forcing Ari to move to the side. She did it to give me a better view. She folded into a submissive position, her ass in the air for Ari, and her face on the bed, pressed into the pillows.

Ari had his belt in one hand but he only looked down at Ela's ass. Evidently waiting for something he had told her to do.

I strained to watch, and then I saw what he was so absorbed by: Ela was working her violinist fingers up from between her legs, to her wet, engorged slit. Her lips parted with a sticky yawn, as she pulled them apart to display herself for Ari.

His cock throbbed in the air.

He gave the belt a little crack across her right buttock, and Ela gasped. Her fingers moved with more purpose, fluttering to pull herself apart even more.

Another slap of the belt – not hard, just enough to make a noise and to probably sting – cut across Ela's ass again. “How bad have you been, Ela? How much punishment do you need?”

Another slap on her ass, and I saw Ela's fingers moving more quickly. She gasped and moaned into the pillow.

I knew I could never slap my wife this way. But as Ari raised the belt again and let it crack across the other side of her ass with a sharp snap, my cock thrashed around wildly in my hand. I wanted him to give her another, sound slap. Again and again.

Ela was now bringing herself to orgasm. Her fingers were fluttering wetly in her own juicy cunt. She rocked her hips slightly as crack after crack of Ari's belt reddened her ass. She yelled into the pillow as she came, and Ari looked down at her, panting with his own exertion and lust, watching, probably, her pussy well up with her own cum.

He dropped the belt and grasped her ass with two hands. He pulled apart her cheeks and used his thumbs to stroke her pussy juices upward from her gushing cunt, to her ass. She twitched as he stroked her clit, but his large hands held her immobile. His thumbs smeared her cum upward, to where it glistened over her asshole.

I couldn't see all of this in great detail, of course, but I could imagine it. I knew, by the way Ela seized up and froze in his hands, that he had plunged both of his thumbs inward, perforating her tight ass with two big fingers at the same time.

Ela moaned into the pillows. “Ooooooh,” she said.

“It's okay,” Ari said absently, but he had no intention of releasing her from his vice grip.

“Please, Ari, no, it hurts.”

But he didn't stop, he only pressed his thumbs in further, and Ela pressed her face into the bedsheets and wailed. But she took it.

Ari leaned forward, and with his hands turning my wife's ass almost inside-out, his thumbs hooked inside of her and his palms grasping her small ass to keep it still, he leaned forward and guided his cock to her pussy. His thumbs were hooked outward in her asshole, so that he could pull her toward him to slide her pussy over his cock.

His member slid in, inch by inch, until he had himself inside of her. He shifted his hands so that his fingers pointed upward, toward her lower back, and he began to push and pull her. His thumbs were still inside of her ass. Ela rose up to her hands and knees, and tossed her hair back. Then she turned to the side and looked toward me, so that I could see her face as she gasped and opened her mouth wide. Ari slammed into her rapidly, pounding her pussy and holding her steady with his thumb-to-ass grip. Ela's moans rattled with the pounding.

But she came again. I saw her body tense and she looked skyward, her breath caught in her throat.

"That's it," Ari said, staring down at her gaping ass, and his cock slicking in and out of her cunt. He rammed inside of her pussy, deep into her, and she gasped. He held her there, and I savored the sight of my wife, with her hair sticking to her back with sweat and her eyes closed in pleasure and pain. I could see him pulling his thumbs from inside of her, and she moaned with the agony of it.

Ari's chest was heaving with exertion. He was close to coming and filling her up. She wiggled as his thumbs released from her ass, and he held her buttocks open to watch what I could not see myself: her asshole, gaped and red, spasming closed.

Ari slid from inside of her, and his cock was in the air for a moment, glistening with her cum. His cock was huge now, formidably thick, and so erect that it almost pointed upward. He leaned back and slid his legs with him. In a move that revealed a certain amount of familiarity between the two of them, from long ago, Ela clambered over him until she was hovering above his cock and he could relax on his back, propped up on his elbows.

"Ride my cock," he growled.

My wife, the sweet Ela, rose up on her knees and positioned herself over him, bending slightly forward. She reached a hand backward and grasped his thick member. Her fingers did not even make it all the way around his blunt instrument. She spread her legs apart to slide her body down and point him at the center of her ass.

Ari reached up with one hand and steadied her as she pressed backward, impaling her ass on his cock. It was so thick that at first it bowed slightly from the pressure against her tiny hole, refusing to go in. Ela let out another anguished squeal. "It's too big," she complained, sexily, and turned her face toward me. Her mascara had begun to streak down her cheeks now, as her eyes watered from the sharp pain that Ari's thick cock was delivering to her most intimate hole.

Ari pushed her with a massive hand, pulling her down, grasping her hip with his big paw. And slowly, slowly, he entered her, as she let out a long howl.

Ela's hips moved down, aching slowly, and her ass swallowed Ari's cock inch by inch, until she was sitting on top of him with his cock in her ass.

She tossed her head back, and then forward, and Ari slapped her lightly on the ass. Ela moaned, and began to move up and down. Her small thighs flexed and the line of her muscle became defined as she rose and fell, panting and sweating, sliding her ass up and down the big, thick pole.

Her pussy was so wet that it contributed its own sticky, slurping sound as she moved, and Ela found her rhythm and began to bounce up and down on him, slamming her own ass deeper and deeper onto him with each thrust.

I saw Ari's body tense, and his hand dropped to the side. He fell backward onto the bed, elevating only his head to see his cock disappearing and reappearing in the stretched hole of my wife's ass as she rode him hard.

Her tits bounced in her loosened bra. She rode him for what seemed like an eternity, her face turned slightly toward me. I knew she did it in order to let me see her gloriously filthy face. And then I saw Ari's abdomen tense, and he groaned. With enormous strength, he folded upward and grasped her hips in both hands to push her down and into him, nearly splitting her, as he pummeled his cum inside of her.

Ela was overcome with her pleasure and agony, but she managed to turn toward the screen, and give me the signal we had agreed upon. I was trembling and almost fumbled the phone as I took it from the window-seat behind me and stroked it to life. Her number was ready, and so was the text.

Ela sat on top of him, panting, and Ari was shuddering the last of his cum into her when her phone buzzed.

“Don't,” Ari said, playfully, as Ela laughed and slid off his cock. It dropped with a slap onto his thigh, and I stared at the wet, depleted meat as Ela twisted away and dropped over the side of the bed to remove her phone from her pants. Ari fell back, sighing the contented sigh of a man who has just come.

“Shit!” Ela spat, and it was a really great performance. “Shit, shit, shit. Ari, Ari, you have to go.”

He lifted his head in confusion. She threw his shirt at him and scrambled to the other side of the bed. “He's on his way home.”

This was Ela's plan, from start to finish, and this particular piece of the theater was done so well, and so beautifully, that I had to marvel at my wife. She looked truly, authentically panic-stricken. “Peter!” she shouted at him. “Peter is coming home early.”

“But...won't he be like, 'where is he?' or something like that. How do you know he'll just...leave?” I had asked her.

Ela had smiled coyly. “You're a guy, in some other man's bed, and you just fucked this guy's wife like a whore. What do you do if she starts screaming that he's coming home early?”

She was right, of course. It was an improbable piece of theater, and it made no sense: surely he would reflect upon it later and wonder what the hell had happened. Probably he would conclude that he had somehow been taken for a ride, which didn't bother me in the least. But for now, he reacted as any man probably would. He jumped up and got his clothes on, while Ela gathered her things up from the floor and pretended to be in a rush.

“Just...get out of here,” Ela whispered, and she reached an arm out to give him a quick kiss. The message was clear: she would talk to him later. Now, he had to go.

She knelt on the bed, poised in a hurried, guilty-looking movement, as though she were about to burst into her bathroom and take a shower, and cover up this whole sordid scene, as Ari ran out of the room and down the stairs, barely dressed. His footsteps disappeared in hollow thumps and then the door slammed downstairs.

Ela dropped her clothes and giggled. She turned toward the screen, and peeled a strand of her long hair from her cheek where it was plastered with saliva, sweat, and probably Ari's precum. “Come out, come out, wherever you are,” she beckoned.

This is what Ela had promised me, and now I almost fell down as I staggered from behind the screen to claim the final act of her generous gift. My cock was so hard I could barely breathe.

As I moved out from behind the divider, Ela had dropped to her hands and knees, so when I came around the other side she was there waiting. Her ass was still marked with the belt-slaps, in three long, reddened marks. She had spread her knees apart, and offered me the glorious view of her asshole. It was red and gaped, the darkness in the center gushing with Ari's white cum. It trickled down to her bare snatch, also distended from where he had stretched her out. I got onto my knees behind her, and she turned to me and smiled as I took in the visual for a moment.

I placed a finger inside her ass, and swept it around the circumference of her stretched hole. The slippery feel of another man's cum coated my fingers. The scent of her pussy and his bleachy seed combined and assailed my nostrils.

I was so close to coming that it took only a moment. I slid my cock inside her gushing pussy, and she moaned. She was stretched and loose, and so wet that she seemed to surround me like a liquid instead of flesh. The pressure of my own cock forced even more of the other man's cum from her ass, and I used Ari's own technique to pull her asscheeks apart to get a good view of her asshole, welling up with cum.

Just a few moments of this, and then I felt Ela's pussy tightening around my cock. She yelped as she came again, for a third time, and her ass spasmed and spewed more cum. I was gone. I grasped her by the hips and hammered my own cum deep, deep inside of my naughty, slutty wife.

We remained like that, panting, for some time. Then we rolled onto our backs, and stood staring at the ceiling.

For a brief moment, I thought things might become uncomfortable. But Ela reached out her hand, and let it hang in the air above us, until I took it and entwined my fingers with hers.

"May I ask you something?" I said.

Ela smiled. I suppose it did seem like a strange question, after all of that.

"Are you still satisfied with our sex life?"

Ela snorted, and then, realizing that the question was serious, she turned on her side. "You're not going to get weird on me, are you?"

“I don't think so. I hope not. Just...you know, you seem to enjoy doing all these...” I wasn't sure how to phrase the next bit.

Ela helped me out. “Nasty things. With another man?”

“Yeah. And I..” This was hard conversation. I didn't actually feel like talking so much about it, but I felt I had to.

“You wonder if I want that stuff from you? But you don't really want to do it? You'd rather watch?”

Ela was asking, genuinely, if this was what I wanted to say.

And actually, it really was.

I laughed and fell back to face the ceiling. I rubbed my eyes and shook my head. “It all sounds so simple when you say it.”

“I thought we had this all straightened out.” There was a note of worry in her voice.

I rolled over, and moved my hand down her body. Her small, firm breasts, and her still-hard nipples. When I reached her ribs she scrunched her nose and giggled. But her face went serious.

“Peter,” she said. “Really. It's all just for you. You know that, right? It's...a performance.” She found my hand with hers, and I saw on her face that she was truly concerned. “You know I love *you*, right?”

“I love you Ela,” I breathed. I wanted to say more, but just then, there wasn't any need to say it. I could see from her burning look that she meant her words, and that my insecurities were nonsense. I kissed her neck, and started to move my hand down her body. I could feel myself getting hard again, absorbed by this new thought, this new awareness.

She stopped my hand, and smiled. “I'm unionized,” she said. “And I need a break.”

“Union rules,” I sighed. I supposed it was only fair.

She turned on her side, and bumped against me. Her firm ass was wet with cum. She pulled my arm protectively around her. I breathed in the scent of her sweat and her body, and I nuzzled her neck.

“At least fifteen minutes between performances,” she said.

So we spooned. In the end she fell asleep, in my arms, content.

EPILOGUE

When Ela arrives, she is wearing an elegant black dress beneath a slightly ratty rain poncho. Her legs are slim and mesmerizing, and the dress is short enough that it seems like she is wearing nothing at all beneath the plastic, tarp-like poncho. Unfortunately, she also looks like a hunchback, because her violin is beneath it, on her back.

I see her arrive, getting out of a car. I note, with satisfaction, that it is Ari's car. He keeps her there for a moment or two, probably flirting, but Ela ultimately waves him away and climbs the steps to our house. Poor sap. He's probably always hoping for a repeat performance from Ela, and she has no intention of giving him one.

I almost feel sorry for him.

I note with a similar satisfaction that many eyes follow me to the door. Tom, who I know has been waiting for Ela to arrive, and Aaron, who is always waiting for any new female to appear on the scene. I know that behind my back, plenty of male eyes are being sucked to the entranceway of our house, where Ela is shaking herself off. She's quite a sight, with her poncho over her violin to keep the case dry, and her long, elegant legs hanging from beneath the dripping plastic.

She drops the hood back, though, and beneath it her hair is perfect, wound in an elegant style for a concert performance. Her cheeks are flushed from the cool night.

She unbuttons the poncho, and inch by inch her smooth, creamy chest is revealed. She gives me an impish look as she does this, because we share now the awareness and the fun of knowing that many men are watching her from the corner of their eyes. Hoping that in fact, the illusion of her nakedness beneath the poncho is real, and the plastic will fall away button by button until it reveals the dip between her breasts, her bare navel, and finally, her bare snatch, where only a pink gash marks her femininity. She's kept that look, because I find it so enticing, knowing she's always bare there, waiting to be opened like a dewy flower...petal by petal.

Ela sees what I am thinking and she smiles.

The poncho reveals only a very conservative, elegant dress. It comes to her knees, and the hunchback she seemed to have turns into her violin.

She places the case high on a shelf in the closet, standing on tiptoes, revealing her long thigh.

“How's the party?” she says, her eyes sweeping over the guests when she turns back to me.

“Better now.”

“Good,” she says, taking the glass of wine that I offer her. “I guess I'll get busy, then.”

I lean close to her. “Don't ruin it,” I say, running my fingers along her side.

Ela winks at me, and saunters off. Today's dress hides her ass, but as she swishes along, it clings to her and reveals a tantalizing taste of its shape. It's almost more sexy than a tight skirt.

Eyes follow her, and I think about this with a shiver of excitement.

I don't know where our new lifestyle will take us, or even if we will decide to take it as far as we did with Ari again. All I know is that our sex life is tremendous now, and that I have a deeper confidence in my wife's real love for me, because we decided to push the boundaries of our relationship. Doing what we did opened up the doors to greater honesty between us in all things.

And I know now, as Ela leans close to make a joke, or lets an arm rest on another man's forearm as she punctuates some point she's making, or as she laughs at someone else's joke: it's all a performance.

A performance for me.

Like right now. Ela is seductively grazing her lower lip with her fingers as she listens to Aaron. She's giving him a look, but she chooses a moment to break away, and wink at me without winking.

“That's your wife?” Henry Polk says, nudging me gently as he sides up to me. He's new at the firm. “No fucking way. I mean, people said she was hot...but...”

I turn to Henry. He's a young, good-looking guy with a tight stomach and what I've heard the ladies at the firm refer to as a “nice ass.” He seems like a dirty-minded fellow.

I shrug, as if there's nothing that can be done about it. I take a sip of my wine. Ela laughs.

“Want me to introduce you?” I say.

Who knows?

They might hit it off.

END

Thank you for reading. I hope you enjoyed my story as much as I enjoyed writing it.

Please don't forget to leave a review...it's the best compliment I can receive, and it helps boost sales and get my stories out to the readers who want them, so I can keep writing more long works like these for you to enjoy!

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*If you enjoyed Ela's Performance,
give my other novels a try!*

[*The Hotwife Tattoo*](#)

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to is wife – maybe even himself?

[*The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel*](#)

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken.

But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White , with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

NOVELLAS BY ARNICA

Try To Have Some Fun

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Claire's Cowboy

When he gives his wife Claire the gift of a vacation of her choice, Chris is perplexed when she wants to go on a horseback-riding adventure in Montana. Nothing about that kind of trip has ever appealed to Claire. Next, she mentions a mysterious ex-lover, and she turns out to be nearly a professional at riding horses. Chris can't help but wonder if her choice of vacation, and the rugged man who will lead the tour, are just an uncanny coincidence...or if there is something more to Claire's cowboy?

Nothing Better To Do

Rob is finding out from the locals in his wife's small mountain hometown that his soccer-mom wife Kirsten may have been quite a different person once upon a time. He'll find out the truth first-hand when a late summer blizzard traps everyone at a party, and his wife comes up with some very indecent ideas for passing the time.

After all, there's nothing better to do...

**If you're a new fan of Arnica Butler, why don't
you try *Wives Gone Wild*?**

I've put together ten of my short stories about wives on vacation, who get taken every way you can think of while their husbands watch. **Ten stories for \$4.99!** For fans of my longer hotwife novels, these stories may not be

for you (but then again...they might). These are quick or medium-length, dirty stories about men taking willing wives right out from under their husbands' noses. Most include very graphic scenes of humiliation, menage, cleanup and...well, that's all I can write about here!

Stories included in this bundle are: ***Double-Cucked; Cuckolded in Texas by The Oil Tycoon; Watching My Wife Get Trucked; St. Paddy's Day Cucktale; A Long Hard Winter; Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked; My Wife Goes Back To Black; Cuckolded On A Plane!; Cuckolded In Vegas!; and Cuckolded on My Dominican Vacation.***

All stories are available for purchase individually for \$2.99 and some are in Kindle Unlimited for free, with the exception of Cuckolded In Texas, which is only available here. I want to give readers a chance to read some of my earlier works and quickies at a discounted price.

Because sometimes, you just want to get down and dirty, right?
Enjoy!